

Beyond the Rejection

A Novel of Dreams, Purpose, and Perseverance

Copyright Page

Beyond the Rejection

Copyright © 2026 Mohamed Jassar

All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, distributed, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording, or otherwise, without prior written permission from the copyright holder, except for brief quotations used in reviews or scholarly works.

This is a work of fiction inspired by real-life experiences. Names, characters, organizations, places, events, and incidents are either the product of the author's imagination or are used fictitiously. Any resemblance to actual persons, living or deceased, or actual events is coincidental except where the author has intentionally drawn on personal experiences as inspiration.

First Edition – 2026

Written by **Mohamed Jassar**

Dedication

To my parents,

Thank you for believing in me during the seasons when success seemed far away. Your love, patience, and sacrifices became the foundation upon which every dream was built.

To every dreamer who has ever received another rejection email,

This book is for you.

May you remember that rejection does not define your future. Sometimes it prepares you for it.

Keep believing.

Keep learning.

Keep moving forward.

Acknowledgements

Writing this novel has been a journey of reflection, gratitude, and hope.

I would like to thank my family for their unwavering support, encouragement, and countless prayers throughout every chapter of my life.

My sincere gratitude goes to my teachers, mentors, friends, and everyone who inspired me to continue learning, even during difficult times.

I am grateful to the many researchers, engineers, innovators, and lifelong learners whose work continues to inspire me to dream beyond limitations.

Most importantly, I thank God for giving me strength during seasons of rejection, courage during moments of uncertainty, and hope when the future seemed unclear.

Every rejection became a lesson.

Every setback became a step forward.

This book exists because hope refused to give up.

Thank you for reading my story.

I hope it encourages you to continue writing yours.

— **Mohamed Jassar**

Prologue

There are moments in life when a single word can change everything.

Sometimes that word is "**Congratulations.**"

More often, for many people, it is "**Unfortunately.**"

This story begins with that word.

Like thousands of graduates around the world, Jas believed that education would open doors. He worked hard, studied tirelessly, and dreamed of building a meaningful career in technology and aerospace.

Instead, he found himself collecting rejection emails.

Days became months.

Months became years.

People measured his life by job titles, salaries, and offer letters.

But they never saw the countless nights he spent learning new skills, writing research papers, developing ideas, traveling to understand the world, or quietly praying for the strength to keep going.

This is not a story about becoming successful overnight.

It is a story about what happens **before** success.

It is about the silent battles that no one applauds.

The interviews that end with polite smiles.

The opportunities that slip away.

The loneliness that follows repeated rejection.

The courage to begin again.

Above all, it is about discovering that your worth is not determined by a company's decision, but by the person you choose to become along the way.

Whether you are searching for your first opportunity, rebuilding after failure, or simply trying to believe in tomorrow, I hope you find a part of yourself within these pages.

Because sometimes the greatest victories are not the jobs we receive...

They are the moments when we decide not to give up.

Welcome to **Beyond the Rejection**. May this journey remind you that every closed door can become the beginning of a new path.

Chapter 1 – The Gold Medal

"Success is celebrated for a day. The journey behind it lasts a lifetime."

The morning sun stretched across the campus like a golden ribbon, warming the old red-brick buildings that had witnessed thousands of dreams over the years. The auditorium buzzed with excitement. Graduates, dressed in black gowns and caps, laughed with their friends while parents searched for their children through the crowd, cameras ready to capture one of the proudest moments of their lives.

For most students, it was the end of a chapter.

For Jas, it felt like the beginning of everything he had worked for.

Standing backstage, he adjusted the gold tassel on his graduation cap and looked at the medal resting in the small velvet box the university had given him. Years of sleepless nights, difficult exams, laboratory projects, coding competitions, and technical presentations had led to this moment.

His palms were damp.

Not because he was nervous.

Because he was grateful.

His phone vibrated.

A message from his mother appeared.

Mother: *We're in the second row. We can already see you. Your father has been smiling since morning.*

Jas smiled.

His father rarely showed emotion.

Seeing him proud meant more than any award.

The announcer's voice echoed through the auditorium.

"Today's Gold Medal in Information Technology goes to..."

A pause.

"...Mr. Jas."

Applause filled the hall.

Jas walked across the stage with calm steps, though his heart raced. The Vice Chancellor shook his hand and placed the medal around his neck.

"Congratulations, young man," the Vice Chancellor said quietly. "Keep learning. The world needs people who solve problems."

Those words settled deep in Jas's heart.

He accepted the certificate with both hands, bowed respectfully, and turned toward the audience.

His parents were standing.

His mother wiped tears from her eyes.

His father clapped proudly.

For one brief moment, the world seemed perfect.

Outside the auditorium, classmates gathered for photographs.

"C'mon, Gold Medalist!" shouted Arun, wrapping an arm around Jas's shoulder. "Now you'll be the first one in our batch to join a multinational company."

Everyone laughed.

Another friend added,

"Don't forget us when you're earning in dollars."

Jas smiled modestly.

"I'll never forget."

Deep inside, he believed them.

He had good grades.

Strong technical knowledge.

Projects.

Internships.

Research ideas.

Confidence.

Surely getting a job would only be a matter of time.

That evening, Jas returned home carrying flowers, gifts, and the gold medal.

His mother carefully placed the medal inside a glass cabinet.

His father looked at it for a long moment.

"I couldn't finish my education," he said softly.

"But today..."

He looked at Jas.

"...I feel like I graduated too."

Jas hugged him.

Neither of them spoke.

Some emotions were too big for words.

After dinner, while everyone slept, Jas entered his small room.

The walls were simple.

A bookshelf filled one corner.

Programming books.

Cybersecurity.

Artificial Intelligence.

Satellite Communication.

Aerospace Engineering.

Network Security.

Rocket Propulsion.

His interests were scattered across disciplines, but they all shared one purpose:

To build something useful.

He sat before his old laptop.

The screen glowed softly.

A blank résumé stared back at him.

He spent hours refining every line.

Education.

Projects.

Skills.

Achievements.

Gold Medal.

Research interests.

Programming languages.

He reviewed every word three times.

At two in the morning, he leaned back in his chair.

"This is it," he whispered.

He opened a job portal.

The cursor hovered over the **Apply** button.

His heart beat faster.

He clicked.

Application submitted.

Then another.

Then another.

Five applications.

Ten.

Twenty.

Each click carried a small dream.

Before closing the laptop, he folded his hands.

"God," he prayed quietly, "You gave me knowledge. Help me use it well. I don't ask for wealth. I only ask for an opportunity."

The room fell silent.

Outside, rain began to fall.

The following weeks were filled with excitement.

Every morning, Jas checked his email before brushing his teeth.

Nothing.

He refreshed the page.

Still nothing.

"No worries," he told himself.

"Companies take time."

He continued learning.

He completed online certifications.

Practiced coding problems.

Built small applications.

Studied interview questions.

Researched aerospace innovations late into the night simply because they fascinated him.

He wasn't studying only to get a job.

He genuinely loved learning.

One afternoon, his younger cousin visited.

"So..." the boy asked excitedly.

"When are you joining your company?"

Jas laughed.

"Soon, I hope."

His aunt smiled confidently.

"With your marks, companies will fight over you."

Everyone laughed.

Jas believed that too.

Days turned into weeks.

Weeks became a month.

Still no interview.

He refreshed his inbox dozens of times each day.

One morning, an email finally arrived.

His heart raced.

The subject line read:

Application Update

His hands trembled slightly as he opened it.

He expected congratulations.

Instead, he read:

Dear Applicant,

Thank you for your interest in joining our organization.

After careful consideration...

Unfortunately...

The word seemed heavier than all the others.

Unfortunately.

He stared at the screen.

Not angry.

Not broken.

Just... silent.

His first rejection.

He closed the laptop slowly.

Walked outside.

Looked toward the sky.

Then smiled faintly.

"It's alright," he whispered to himself.

"It's only one."

He had no idea that this single word—

Unfortunately

—would soon become the most familiar word in his life.

Chapter 2 – Unfortunately...

"Sometimes a single word can become the loudest voice in your life."

The sound of a new email notification had become the highlight of Jas's mornings.

Every sunrise began the same way.

Before brushing his teeth...

Before making tea...

Before speaking to anyone...

He opened his laptop.

The internet connected.

His inbox loaded.

His heart waited.

Every day, he hoped today would be different.

One Monday morning, another email arrived.

Subject: Application Status

Jas smiled.

"This must be it."

He opened the message.

Dear Jas,

Thank you for taking the time to apply.

We appreciate your interest in our company.

After careful consideration...

Unfortunately...

He stopped reading.

The word had become painfully familiar.

He closed the laptop and looked out of the window.

Children were walking to school.

Office workers hurried toward buses.

Delivery riders rushed through traffic.

Everyone seemed to know where they were going.

Except him.

By the end of that week, five more emails had arrived.

Each one began politely.

Each one ended the same way.

Unfortunately...

Jas did something unusual.

Instead of deleting them, he created a folder.

He named it:

"Reasons to Keep Going."

His mother noticed.

"Why don't you delete them?"

Jas smiled gently.

"Because one day I'll read them again."

"Why?"

"So I'll remember how far I came."

She didn't understand.

But she admired his strength.

The weeks turned into months.

His daily routine became almost mechanical.

Wake up.

Pray.

Search job portals.

Tailor his résumé for each company.

Write cover letters.

Complete coding assessments.

Attend webinars.

Learn a new programming language.

Study cybersecurity.

Read aerospace journals before bed.

Repeat.

Some days he applied to thirty companies.

Other days...

Only three.

Not because he was tired.

Because he had already applied almost everywhere.

One afternoon his father returned from the market.

A neighbour had stopped him.

"So..."

the neighbour had asked,

"Your son got a gold medal.

Which company is he working for?"

His father smiled politely.

"He's searching."

The neighbour nodded.

"Oh..."

That single word carried disappointment.

When his father reached home, he said nothing.

Jas knew.

He could read the silence.

That evening they ate dinner quietly.

No one mentioned jobs.

No one mentioned interviews.

Sometimes silence spoke louder than conversation.

Social media became another battlefield.

One friend posted:

"First day at Google!"

Another:

"Joined Microsoft."

Another:

"Life in Dubai begins today."

Another:

"My first salary!"

Jas smiled and clicked "Like."

He was genuinely happy for them.

But after putting the phone down...

The room suddenly felt heavier.

Not because he envied them.

Because he wondered...

"When will my turn come?"

He opened his notebook.

Instead of writing about disappointment, he wrote:

****Success is not a race.**

My lane is different.

I just don't know where it leads yet.**

He underlined the last sentence.

Three times.

Weeks later, an interview invitation finally arrived.

A multinational company.

Jas almost couldn't believe it.

He spent four days preparing.

Data structures.

Networking.

Operating systems.

Cybersecurity.

Programming.

Behavioural questions.

Everything.

The interview lasted nearly an hour.

The interviewer smiled.

"You've prepared well."

Jas walked out feeling hopeful.

For the first time in months...

Hope felt real.

Three days later...

Another email.

Dear Jas...

Unfortunately...

He didn't finish reading.

He closed the laptop.

Walked outside.

Sat beneath a large banyan tree near his house.

Children played cricket nearby.

Birds chirped above him.

Life continued.

His felt paused.

That night sleep refused to come.

Two o'clock.

Three o'clock.

Four.

He stared at the ceiling.

"What am I doing wrong?"

he whispered.

No answer came.

He got out of bed.

Opened his laptop.

Instead of searching for jobs...

He opened a blank document.

At the top he typed:

Problems Worth Solving

Below it he wrote:

- Affordable healthcare technology.
- Cybersecurity for small businesses.
- Sustainable aviation.
- Satellite communication in remote villages.
- AI for disaster response.

He looked at the list.

For the first time in weeks...

He smiled.

"If nobody gives me work..."

he whispered,

"I'll create work."

The next morning, he transformed the corner of his bedroom into something new.

One side held books.

Another held engineering sketches.

Sticky notes covered the wall.

Ideas.

Algorithms.

Research questions.

Flight designs.

Programming diagrams.

His mother peeked inside.

"What are you doing?"

Jas grinned.

"Building my own laboratory."

She laughed.

"In this tiny room?"

He nodded confidently.

"The world's biggest ideas don't always begin in big buildings."

Every rejection still hurt.

Every email still stung.

But something inside him had started changing.

Earlier...

He waited for opportunities.

Now...

He was preparing to create them.

Late that evening, he looked once more at the folder named **Reasons to Keep Going**.

It already contained nearly one hundred rejection emails.

He counted them quietly.

One hundred.

Then he closed the folder and whispered,

"One day...

This folder will become the first chapter of my success story."

Outside, rain began to fall gently against the window.

Jas watched the drops race down the glass.

Some disappeared halfway.

Others reached the bottom.

He smiled.

"Not every drop reaches the ground...

but every drop still falls with purpose."

He switched off the light.

Tomorrow would bring more applications.

Perhaps more rejection.

Perhaps something else.

Whatever awaited him...

He would face it.

One email at a time.

Chapter 3 – The Weight of Expectations

"The heaviest burdens are often carried in silence."

Three months had passed since graduation.

The gold medal still rested inside the glass cabinet in the living room.

Visitors admired it.

Relatives praised it.

Neighbours smiled whenever they saw it.

But every compliment ended with the same question.

"So... where is he working now?"

Jas had begun to dislike that question.

Not because he didn't want to answer.

Because he had no answer.

One Sunday afternoon, the family attended a cousin's engagement ceremony.

The marriage hall overflowed with laughter.

Children chased one another between rows of chairs.

The aroma of traditional food filled the air.

Everywhere Jas looked, people seemed happy.

He stood quietly beside his parents, greeting relatives with a polite smile.

An elderly uncle walked toward him.

"There he is!"

"The Gold Medalist!"

He patted Jas on the shoulder.

"So, which company?"

Jas smiled.

"I'm still searching."

The uncle's smile faded.

"Oh..."

Then came the advice.

"You should lower your expectations."

"Take any job."

"Nowadays degrees alone are useless."

Another relative joined the conversation.

"My neighbour's son didn't even finish college."

"He already earns twice as much."

The group laughed.

Jas forced himself to smile.

Inside...

Every sentence felt heavier than the last.

His mother noticed.

On the drive home she remained unusually quiet.

Finally she spoke.

"They don't understand."

Jas looked out the window.

"It's alright, Amma."

"They only see today."

"They don't know what tomorrow looks like."

His mother smiled gently.

"You still believe?"

Jas nodded.

"More than yesterday."

The next morning began exactly as before.

Laptop.

Job portals.

Applications.

Resume updates.

Cover letters.

Interview preparation.

Hours passed.

Nothing.

Jas closed the browser and leaned back in his chair.

His eyes drifted toward the bookshelf.

There were books on cybersecurity.

Artificial intelligence.

Rocket propulsion.

Embedded systems.

Machine learning.

Network security.

Satellite communication.

Most people asked him,

"What job do you want?"

Very few asked,

"What do you love learning?"

The answer was simple.

Everything.

He loved solving problems.

That evening, while browsing an aerospace journal, he read an article about satellite communication in remote regions.

A thought appeared.

"What if emergency communication systems could work without expensive infrastructure?"

He opened a notebook.

Within minutes the first sketch appeared.

Then another.

By midnight, pages covered the desk.

Algorithms.

Flowcharts.

Notes.

Ideas.

No company had asked him to build them.

No professor had assigned the work.

He simply couldn't ignore an interesting problem.

The following week another interview invitation arrived.

A multinational software company.

Jas prepared for days.

The interview room was bright.

The interviewer smiled politely.

"Tell me about yourself."

Jas answered confidently.

They discussed networking.

Programming.

Cybersecurity.

Cloud computing.

Artificial intelligence.

The interviewer nodded often.

"You seem passionate."

"I am."

"Do you have industry experience?"

Jas hesitated.

"No."

The interviewer's expression softened.

"We're currently looking for someone with experience."

Jas smiled politely.

"I understand."

He walked out of the building already knowing the result.

Three days later...

Another email.

Unfortunately...

He stared at the word for several seconds.

Then quietly closed the laptop.

No anger.

No tears.

Only silence.

Late that night, unable to sleep, Jas climbed to the rooftop.

The city lights shimmered beneath a cloudy sky.

A cool breeze carried the scent of rain.

He looked upward.

Thousands of stars.

Some brighter than others.

Some barely visible.

Yet every one of them remained exactly where it belonged.

He folded his hands.

"God..."

His voice was almost a whisper.

"I don't understand."

"I studied."

"I worked hard."

"I prepared."

"I never cheated anyone."

"So why does every door close?"

The wind answered with silence.

Jas smiled faintly.

"I know."

"You don't always answer immediately."

"I'll wait."

He remained there for nearly an hour.

Not asking for success.

Only asking for strength.

Days became weeks.

Friends called less often.

Group chats became quieter.

Some had moved abroad.

Others had married.

Many had busy careers.

Jas celebrated every achievement they shared.

But after congratulating them...

He returned to his own quiet room.

His world remained unchanged.

One afternoon, while scrolling through professional networking sites, he noticed another rejection.

This one was different.

Instead of feeling disappointed...

He clicked "New Project."

He created a folder.

Healthcare Innovations

Inside it he began writing ideas.

Affordable cancer screening.

AI-assisted diagnosis.

Portable health monitoring.

His thoughts flowed faster than he could type.

Hours disappeared unnoticed.

When his mother entered with tea, she smiled.

"You forgot lunch."

Jas looked at the clock.

It was almost evening.

"I'm sorry."

"What were you doing?"

He looked at the diagrams on the screen.

"Thinking."

She laughed softly.

"You've always done that too much."

He grinned.

"And I probably always will."

A few days later, a neighbour visited.

He looked around the room.

Books.

Research papers.

Sticky notes.

Engineering drawings.

The man frowned.

"You spend all day studying?"

Jas nodded.

"Yes."

"Without a job?"

"Yes."

The man shook his head.

"Waste of time."

After he left, Jas remained silent.

His father sat beside him.

"Did those words hurt?"

Jas thought for a moment.

"A little."

"But only because people think learning has value only when someone pays for it."

His father placed a hand on his shoulder.

"I don't fully understand your work."

"But I understand one thing."

"You've never stopped trying."

That meant more to Jas than any interview invitation.

That night he opened his journal.

He wrote slowly.

People measure success by salary.

I measure success by whether I learned something new today.

One day...

I hope those two paths meet.

He closed the notebook.

Turned off the light.

Outside, the rain finally began.

Each drop struck the roof gently.

Jas listened carefully.

Some people heard rain.

He heard possibility.

Tomorrow would bring more applications.

More learning.

Perhaps another rejection.

But also...

Another chance to become someone better than yesterday.

He smiled in the darkness.

The world still hadn't given him an opportunity.

So he decided...

He would keep preparing for it anyway.

Chapter 4 – The Invisible Engineer

"The world saw an unemployed graduate. It never saw the engineer working through the night."

The email notification appeared once again.

Jas didn't rush toward his laptop anymore.

He already knew what waited inside.

Another rejection.

Another polite apology.

Another company choosing someone else.

He clicked the email anyway.

Dear Jas,

Thank you for your interest...

Unfortunately...

He closed the browser before reaching the last paragraph.

For the first time...

The rejection didn't hurt.

Not because he had become stronger.

Because he had become tired.

His room had slowly transformed over the past few months.

It no longer looked like a student's bedroom.

Books were stacked from the floor to the edge of the desk.

Programming.

Artificial Intelligence.

Computer Vision.

Satellite Communication.

Cybersecurity.

Rocket Propulsion.

Healthcare Systems.

Wireless Communication.

Drone Technology.

Aircraft Design.

Sticky notes covered the wall.

Some contained equations.

Others carried half-finished ideas.

A large whiteboard stood beside the window.

Across the top he had written in bold letters:

Problems Worth Solving

Below that title were dozens of questions.

"Can AI detect cancer earlier?"

"Can satellite communication reach villages after disasters?"

"Can drones deliver medicine to remote mountains?"

"Can aircraft become carbon neutral?"

"How can hospitals defend against ransomware?"

Nobody had asked him to solve them.

Nobody was paying him.

Yet every morning...

He returned to that board.

One afternoon his mother entered quietly carrying coffee.

She stopped near the whiteboard.

"So many questions."

Jas smiled.

"I like questions."

"What about answers?"

"They take longer."

She laughed.

"You've been sitting here since morning."

"I know."

"Did you even eat?"

He scratched his head.

"I forgot."

His mother sighed with the familiar expression every mother has when her child forgets the world around him.

"You can't solve the world's problems on an empty stomach."

Jas smiled.

"That's probably true."

After lunch he opened a blank folder on his computer.

Research Project 01

AI-Assisted Early Cancer Screening

He had read about hospitals in rural areas struggling with early diagnosis.

Doctors worked tirelessly.

Equipment was limited.

Many patients arrived too late.

He wasn't a doctor.

He reminded himself of that constantly.

But perhaps...

Artificial Intelligence could become another tool.

For weeks he studied published medical research.

He learned how machine learning models recognized patterns.

He explored ethical concerns.

He read scientific papers until sunrise.

Sometimes he understood everything.

Sometimes...

He understood almost nothing.

But every day...

He learned something new.

His father watched all this with quiet curiosity.

One evening he asked,

"Who gave you this project?"

Jas looked up from his laptop.

"No one."

His father looked confused.

"Then why are you doing it?"

Jas leaned back.

"If nobody starts..."

Nothing changes."

His father nodded slowly.

"I may not understand computers."

"But I understand determination."

Months passed.

The healthcare research slowly took shape.

It wasn't perfect.

It wasn't revolutionary.

But it was honest work.

Jas documented every idea carefully.

Then...

He submitted it.

Not to one organization.

To several.

Universities.

Research institutions.

Innovation programs.

Healthcare initiatives.

He waited.

The replies arrived over the next few weeks.

Some thanked him.

Some never responded.

One email stood out.

Thank you for your proposal.

Unfortunately, we only accept research conducted through recognized academic institutions.

Jas stared at the sentence.

He smiled sadly.

"So...

My idea isn't rejected."

He whispered.

"I am."

For a moment...

He considered deleting everything.

Months of work.

Thousands of lines of notes.

Weeks of sleepless nights.

What was the point?

No laboratory.

No professor.

No funding.

No organization.

Just one man...

Working inside a small bedroom.

He closed his eyes.

Then remembered something his grandfather once said.

"Knowledge becomes powerful only when it is shared."

He opened his laptop again.

Instead of deleting the project...

He uploaded it freely.

Publicly.

Anyone could read it.

Anyone could improve it.

Anyone could build something better.

He added one sentence at the end.

If this research helps even one person in the future, it has already succeeded.

He clicked **Publish**.

For the first time in weeks...

He felt peace.

That evening he walked through the nearby park.

Children chased butterflies.

An elderly couple shared roasted peanuts.

A young boy pointed toward the sky.

"One day I'll become a pilot."

His father smiled proudly.

"You will."

Jas stopped walking.

He looked upward.

Aircraft crossed the evening sky.

White contrails stretched across the blue horizon.

He smiled.

"My turn will come."

Not because someone promised.

Because he still believed.

Days later...

He started another folder.

Research Project 02

This time...

Cybersecurity.

Hospitals around the world had become victims of ransomware attacks.

Patient data disappeared.

Operations stopped.

Lives were placed at risk.

Jas believed cybersecurity wasn't just about protecting computers.

It was about protecting people.

Again...

He studied.

Built prototypes.

Created algorithms.

Designed frameworks.

Nobody saw the work.

While relatives believed he was "doing nothing"...

He often worked eighteen hours a day.

Sometimes more.

His inbox continued growing.

Job applications.

Research submissions.

Interview requests.

Rejections.

By now...

Nearly three hundred companies had said no.

But another number had quietly grown as well.

Two complete research projects.

Three software prototypes.

Countless notebooks filled with ideas.

He looked around his room.

No trophies.

No certificates.

No salary.

Yet...

He had built something far more valuable.

Discipline.

Late that night...

Rain struck the window.

The city slept.

Only the soft glow of Jas's monitor illuminated the room.

He opened a fresh notebook.

On the first page he wrote:

People think unemployment means doing nothing.

Only God knows how many invisible battles happen inside a quiet room.

He underlined the sentence.

Closed the notebook.

Folded his hands.

"Thank You..."

he whispered.

"Not for making life easy."

"But for giving me a reason to keep learning."

Outside...

The rain continued.

Inside...

Another idea had already begun.

Chapter 5 – The Researcher Without a Laboratory

"Ideas do not ask where they are born. Only people do."

The monsoon arrived quietly.

Every evening, dark clouds gathered over the city, and rain washed the dust from the streets.

Children played barefoot in puddles while shopkeepers pulled plastic sheets over their stalls.

For Jas, rain meant something different.

It meant another night at his desk.

The rhythmic sound of raindrops against his bedroom window became the background music of his life.

His room remained awake long after the rest of the house had fallen asleep.

A lamp illuminated stacks of books.

Engineering journals.

Cybersecurity manuals.

Research papers.

A notebook lay open beside his keyboard.

Across the top of the page he had written:

"Innovation begins where comfort ends."

The rejection emails continued to arrive.

They no longer surprised him.

He read them calmly, archived them, and returned to his work.

He had stopped waiting for opportunity.

Instead, he had started chasing purpose.

One evening, while reading an article about emerging aerospace technologies, he paused.

He noticed a recurring theme.

As technology advanced, new challenges appeared just as quickly.

He leaned back in his chair.

"What if," he whispered, "instead of only building better systems, we focused on protecting people from new threats?"

That question stayed with him for days.

He filled pages of notes—not about building weapons, but about ways future technologies might improve safety, resilience, and defense against rapidly changing challenges.

He wasn't trying to design something destructive.

He was fascinated by the idea of protecting lives.

Weeks passed.

His desk disappeared beneath handwritten calculations, diagrams, and references.

His mother entered his room carrying tea.

She laughed softly.

"I think your books are taking over the house."

Jas smiled without looking away from the screen.

"They're good roommates."

She placed the cup beside him.

"You've been sitting here since morning."

"I'm almost finished."

"You said that yesterday."

"And the day before."

He finally looked up and smiled.

"I know."

She gently placed a hand on his shoulder.

"I don't understand everything you're studying."

"You don't have to."

"I only want one thing."

"What?"

"Take care of yourself while you're trying to take care of the world."

For a moment...

Neither of them spoke.

Three months later...

The research was complete.

It wasn't perfect.

Jas knew that.

No research ever was.

But it represented months of careful study, revision, and learning.

He formatted the document neatly.

Reviewed every page.

Checked every reference twice.

Before clicking "Send," he closed his eyes.

"God...

If this idea has value,

let it reach the right people.

If not,

teach me through the rejection."

He clicked.

The email disappeared into cyberspace.

Now...

He could only wait.

Waiting had become another profession.

Days passed.

Then weeks.

Every email notification made his heart race.

But most messages came from job portals.

"New opportunities."

"Recommended positions."

"Application updates."

He continued applying for jobs while waiting for a response to his research.

One afternoon, the reply finally arrived.

The sender belonged to a respected national research organization.

His hands trembled slightly.

He opened the message.

The first paragraph thanked him for his interest.

The second acknowledged the effort he had invested.

Then came the sentence that quietly changed the room.

At present, we are only able to evaluate proposals submitted through recognized institutional or academic channels.

He read it again.

And again.

There was no criticism of his work.

No insult.

Only a policy.

Still...

The outcome was the same.

His proposal could not move forward.

Jas closed the laptop.

For several minutes he simply sat in silence.

The rain tapped against the window.

A ceiling fan hummed softly overhead.

The world continued as usual.

Inside the room...

Everything felt still.

He wasn't angry.

He understood that organizations had procedures.

But he couldn't stop wondering.

"What happens to ideas that come from ordinary people?"

That evening his father found him sitting on the veranda.

"You've been quiet."

Jas nodded.

"My proposal wasn't accepted."

His father sat beside him.

"Was it because the idea was bad?"

"No."

"Then why?"

"They have rules."

His father looked toward the rain.

"Rules are important."

"I know."

"But sometimes I wish ideas could be judged before titles."

His father smiled gently.

"You know..."

"When I was young,

I thought success meant people opening doors for me."

He looked at Jas.

"Now I think success is continuing to knock,

even when the doors stay closed."

Jas smiled.

"I'll keep knocking."

The next morning he opened the research file once more.

He hovered over the Delete button.

Months of work.

Late nights.

Sacrificed weekends.

Endless revisions.

One click...

And everything would disappear.

His finger stopped.

He remembered something written in his notebook months earlier.

Knowledge grows when it is shared.

Slowly...

He clicked another button instead.

Upload.

He published the research on an open platform where students, educators, and researchers could read it, learn from it, and build upon it.

He wasn't seeking fame.

He simply refused to let the work vanish into silence.

At the end of the document he added a note.

This work is shared freely in the hope that it encourages further research. Every idea becomes stronger when others improve it.

He smiled.

For the first time since receiving the rejection...

He felt lighter.

That evening he stood on the rooftop.

The rain clouds had cleared.

Stars filled the sky.

He thought about the thousands of scientists whose names history had forgotten.

People whose ideas had inspired others.

Perhaps...

Recognition wasn't the only measure of success.

Perhaps...

Planting a seed was enough.

He folded his hands in prayer.

"Lord...

If my name is never remembered,

let my work still help someone.

'That is enough."

A cool breeze crossed the rooftop.

Jas looked upward.

The stars hadn't changed.

But something inside him had.

He realized that purpose did not require permission.

It required persistence.

Chapter 6 – The People Who Stayed

"The world remembers those who celebrate your victories. Life teaches you to treasure those who stay during your defeats."

The calendar had changed again.

Another year had quietly arrived.

For most people, New Year's Day meant celebrations, fireworks, and resolutions.

For Jas...

It meant another notebook.

He always began each year with a fresh notebook.

The first page remained the same.

Goals

Learn.

Build.

Help.

Never give up.

He never wrote,

"Get rich."

He never wrote,

"Become famous."

Instead, he wrote one sentence at the bottom.

Become useful.

Outside, the neighbourhood was waking up.

Children burst crackers.

Families visited relatives.

Social media overflowed with holiday photographs.

"Happy New Year!"

"New beginnings!"

"New job!"

"Promotion!"

"Bought my first car!"

Jas smiled as he wished everyone well.

Then he placed his phone face down.

Comparing his life to others had become exhausting.

He had learned one lesson.

Comparison steals peace faster than failure ever can.

His mother entered the room carrying coffee.

"Happy New Year."

He smiled.

"Happy New Year, Amma."

She looked at the notebook.

"Same goals?"

He laughed.

"Same person."

She sat beside him.

"You know..."

"I've never asked you this."

"What?"

"Are you tired?"

Jas remained silent.

For a long moment.

Then...

"Yes."

"Very."

"But I'm not ready to stop."

His mother nodded slowly.

"I knew that."

Later that afternoon, Jas received a phone call.

It was from one of his hostel friends.

"Hey, Gold Medal!"

Jas laughed.

"Don't call me that."

"Why not?"

"Because life doesn't."

Both laughed.

His friend continued,

"We're meeting this Sunday."

"Everyone?"

"As many as possible."

"You have to come."

Jas hesitated.

"I don't know..."

"You still searching?"

"Yeah."

"So what?"

There was silence.

Then his friend said something Jas would never forget.

"Bro..."

"We're not meeting your salary."

"We're meeting you."

Jas smiled.

"I'll come."

Sunday arrived.

The reunion took place at a small roadside restaurant they had loved during college.

Nothing had changed.

The same wooden tables.

The same tea.

The same noisy owner shouting orders from the kitchen.

One by one...

His hostel friends arrived.

There were hugs.

Laughter.

Old jokes.

Embarrassing memories.

For three hours...

Nobody asked about his salary.

Nobody compared him to anyone.

Nobody questioned his future.

Instead...

They remembered the night electricity went out in the hostel.

The time they cooked noodles illegally using an electric kettle.

The cricket matches.

The exam panic.

The endless laughter.

Finally one friend asked quietly,

"So...

How are you really?"

Jas looked down.

He wasn't used to answering honestly.

"I'm trying."

His friend nodded.

"I know."

Another added,

"You were always the one helping everyone else."

"Now it's our turn."

Jas looked around the table.

For the first time in months...

He didn't feel alone.

After lunch they walked through the college campus.

The classrooms looked smaller.

The corridors felt quieter.

Life had moved on.

One friend pointed toward the auditorium.

"Remember your presentation?"

Everyone laughed.

Jas laughed too.

He also remembered the moments that weren't funny.

The misunderstandings.

The rejection.

The loneliness.

But today...

Those memories hurt less.

Because new memories had begun replacing them.

Before leaving, one friend placed a hand on Jas's shoulder.

"Promise me something."

"What?"

"When you become successful..."

Jas interrupted.

"If."

His friend shook his head.

"No."

"When."

"When you become successful..."

Don't forget these days."

Jas smiled.

"I won't."

A week later...

His phone rang again.

This time it was another hostel friend.

"I've sent you a freelance project."

"Take a look."

The project wasn't large.

The payment wasn't extraordinary.

But to Jas...

It meant something bigger.

Someone believed in his skills.

He completed the work carefully.

The client appreciated the result.

Soon another small project arrived.

Then another.

The income wasn't enough for luxury.

But it covered basic expenses.

More importantly...

It restored something money couldn't buy.

Confidence.

His father noticed the difference.

"You seem happier."

"I've been working."

"Did you get a job?"

"No."

"Then?"

"Freelance."

His father smiled.

"Work is work."

"As long as it is honest."

Jas nodded.

"I don't need a big title."

"I only want honest work."

One evening, while cycling along a quiet road outside the city, Jas stopped near a lake.

The sunset painted the water orange and gold.

Birds flew across the sky.

The world felt peaceful.

He took out his camera.

Photography had become another escape.

Not to impress people.

To remind himself that beauty still existed.

He clicked one photograph after another.

Trees.

Clouds.

Children flying kites.

An elderly fisherman.

A bicycle leaning against a stone wall.

He smiled.

Life wasn't only interviews and rejection emails.

There was still beauty waiting to be noticed.

That night he uploaded a few photographs online.

Someone commented,

"You travel so much.

Do you even work?"

Jas smiled sadly.

People always assumed.

Few ever asked.

He closed the app.

Instead of replying...

He opened his notebook.

He wrote,

People only see one photograph.

They never see the sleepless nights before it.

Never judge someone's life by one moment.

The next morning...

Another rejection email arrived.

He smiled.

Archived it.

Opened his freelance project.

Then returned to his research notes.

For the first time...

The rejection no longer controlled his day.

His purpose did.

Weeks later, one of his hostel friends called again.

"Bro."

"What?"

"Remember what we always said in college?"

Jas laughed.

"Which one?"

His friend smiled.

"If we lose today..."

"We'll win something bigger tomorrow."

Jas looked out of the window.

The evening breeze moved gently through the trees.

"I still believe that."

"So do we."

After ending the call...

Jas realized something.

He didn't have hundreds of friends.

He never did.

But the few who stayed...

Were enough.

Quality had quietly defeated quantity.

That night, before sleeping, he opened his journal.

He wrote one final sentence.

The people who stay beside you during rejection deserve a front-row seat when success finally arrives.

He closed the notebook.

Turned off the light.

Outside...

The stars shone quietly.

Inside...

Hope had become stronger than disappointment.

For the first time in a long while...

Jas slept peacefully.

Chapter 7 – A Window Seat

"Sometimes the longest journey isn't measured in kilometers. It's measured by the distance between who you were and who you're becoming."

The railway station had always fascinated Jas.

Not because of the trains.

Because of the people.

Every platform carried thousands of stories.

Some people laughed while saying goodbye.

Others cried quietly.

Some reunited after years apart.

Others boarded trains toward uncertain futures.

Jas often wondered what every traveler carried besides luggage.

Dreams?

Regrets?

Hope?

Or simply another ordinary day?

He stood on Platform Three holding a small backpack.

Inside were only a few things.

A notebook.

A fountain pen.

His camera.

A water bottle.

A change of clothes.

Nothing more.

He wasn't traveling because he had money.

He was traveling because staying in one place had become heavier than moving.

The train arrived with its familiar metallic roar.

Passengers rushed toward the doors.

Children pointed excitedly at the engine.

Vendors shouted.

"Tea!"

"Coffee!"

"Water bottles!"

Jas smiled.

He always preferred trains over airplanes.

Trains allowed him to watch the world slowly unfold.

He climbed aboard and searched for his favorite place.

A window seat.

Always a window seat.

He placed his bag on the rack above.

As the train began moving, the city slowly disappeared.

Concrete buildings gave way to green fields.

Traffic noise faded into birdsong.

For the first time in weeks...

He took a deep breath.

Across from him sat an elderly man reading a worn-out novel.

Beside the old man was a little girl drawing mountains in a sketchbook.

Her grandmother watched with a gentle smile.

The old man noticed Jas looking outside.

"You like watching the scenery?"

Jas smiled.

"It helps me think."

The old man nodded.

"It helps me remember."

Neither asked another question.

Sometimes strangers understood silence better than friends.

The train passed through villages where children waved enthusiastically.

Jas waved back.

It passed rivers reflecting the afternoon sun.

Farmers worked under wide blue skies.

Palm trees danced in the breeze.

He lifted his camera.

Click.

Click.

Click.

Each photograph captured more than a landscape.

It captured peace.

Hours later, rain began to fall.

Tiny droplets raced across the window glass.

Beyond them, distant hills disappeared into the mist.

Jas opened his notebook.

For several minutes...

He simply stared at the blank page.

Then he wrote one sentence.

"Every rejection pushed me onto another train. Every train showed me another reason to keep living."

He stopped.

Read the sentence again.

Smiled.

Perhaps...

Writing wasn't something he did.

Perhaps...

Writing was becoming who he was.

As evening approached, the train slowed near a small station nestled between hills.

Many passengers stepped off.

A young mother boarded with her son.

The boy couldn't have been older than six.

He looked tired.

His shoes were dusty.

Yet he smiled at everyone he saw.

He eventually walked over to Jas.

"Uncle..."

Jas looked up.

"Yes?"

"Can I sit near the window for a little while?"

Jas smiled immediately.

"Of course."

The little boy climbed onto the seat, his eyes wide with wonder as the train began moving again.

"Wow..."

"So many trees!"

"So many cows!"

"So many birds!"

Everything amazed him.

Jas watched quietly.

The same scenery he had admired for years looked completely new through the eyes of a child.

After a few minutes, the boy looked at him.

"Why were you sitting so quietly?"

Jas thought for a moment.

"I was thinking."

The boy frowned.

"My teacher says thinking too much makes people sad."

Jas laughed.

"Your teacher might be right."

The boy smiled.

"My mother says looking outside makes people happy."

Jas turned toward the window again.

Maybe...

She was right too.

Night settled across the countryside.

Villages glowed softly beneath the stars.

Inside the compartment, most passengers had fallen asleep.

Only the rhythmic sound of the train remained.

Clack...

Clack...

Clack...

Jas rested his forehead against the cool glass.

His thoughts wandered.

He remembered the rejection emails.

The interviews.

The unanswered applications.

The research proposals.

The expectations.

The disappointment.

Then he remembered something else.

Every journey eventually reached another station.

No train stayed still forever.

Perhaps life worked the same way.

Near midnight, the elderly man across from him finally closed his novel.

He looked toward Jas.

"Young man."

"Yes, sir?"

"You've been writing all day."

"A little."

"What do you write?"

Jas hesitated.

"I don't know."

"My thoughts."

"My questions."

"My dreams."

The old man smiled knowingly.

"That's how books begin."

Jas chuckled.

"I'm not an author."

"Neither was every author...

until they wrote the first page."

Those words lingered long after the conversation ended.

The next morning, the train reached the foothills of a mountain range.

Mist floated gently between the trees.

Sunlight pierced through the clouds.

Jas stepped onto the platform during a short stop.

The air smelled of wet earth and pine.

He closed his eyes.

No phone.

No email notifications.

No interview reminders.

Only nature.

He whispered a quiet prayer.

"Thank You, Lord.

For reminding me that life is larger than my disappointments."

He spent the day walking through nearby trails, photographing waterfalls, listening to birds, and sitting beside a flowing stream.

For the first time in many months, he wasn't thinking about finding a job.

He was thinking about finding himself.

As the sun began to set, he opened his notebook one last time.

Across the top of a fresh page, he wrote:

Beyond the Rejection

He stared at the title.

It felt right.

Not because rejection had ended.

But because he had finally begun looking beyond it.

He smiled.

Perhaps this wasn't just the beginning of another journey.

Perhaps...

It was the beginning of his first novel.

Chapter 8 – The Road Less Traveled

"Sometimes life doesn't ask you to choose between success and failure. It asks you to choose between becoming bitter or becoming better."

The train journey changed something inside Jas.

The rejection emails still arrived.

Companies still chose other candidates.

Nothing had changed in the outside world.

But inside...

The storm had begun to settle.

For the first time in years, he stopped asking,

"Why is this happening to me?"

Instead, he asked,

"What can I become because of this?"

Back home, his routine returned.

Wake up.

Pray.

Read.

Apply for jobs.

Complete freelance work.

Study.

Research.

Write.

Travel whenever possible.

Yet each day now carried a different feeling.

Purpose.

One morning, his inbox displayed three new emails.

The first was another rejection.

The second was an advertisement.

The third invited him to an interview.

He smiled.

At least someone had noticed his résumé.

The interview was scheduled for the following week.

For seven days, he prepared with complete dedication.

Programming.

Networking.

Operating Systems.

Cybersecurity.

Behavioral questions.

System Design.

Communication skills.

Every evening, he practiced speaking in front of the mirror.

Not because he lacked knowledge.

Because he was an introvert.

He often knew the answer.

Finding the confidence to speak it aloud was harder.

The interview day arrived.

The company occupied the twentieth floor of a modern glass building.

Employees hurried through the lobby carrying laptops and coffee cups.

Jas adjusted his tie and whispered,

"Lord...

Help me speak with confidence.

Whatever the result,

let me remain peaceful."

He entered the interview room.

Three interviewers greeted him politely.

The first hour went well.

Programming questions.

Problem solving.

Networking.

Database concepts.

Cloud computing.

Everything flowed naturally.

One interviewer smiled.

"You've clearly studied a lot."

"Thank you, sir."

Another asked,

"You've worked on independent research?"

"Yes."

"What kind?"

Jas explained his projects in healthcare technology, cybersecurity, and aerospace.

The interviewers exchanged curious glances.

One of them said,

"You seem interested in many different fields."

Jas smiled.

"I enjoy solving problems."

Finally, the senior interviewer leaned forward.

"One question."

"If you don't have a job...

why spend time on research instead of only preparing for interviews?"

The room became quiet.

Jas thought carefully before answering.

"Because interviews help me earn a living.

Research reminds me why I wanted to become an engineer."

For a moment...

Nobody spoke.

Then the interviewer nodded slowly.

"I like that answer."

Jas left the building feeling hopeful.

Three days later...

The email arrived.

His hands trembled slightly.

He opened it.

Dear Applicant...

Thank you for attending...

Unfortunately...

He closed the laptop.

Walked outside.

Sat beneath the neem tree near his house.

A gentle breeze rustled the leaves.

He laughed quietly.

"What a strange life."

The word **Unfortunately** had become almost like an old acquaintance.

That evening, several relatives visited.

Conversation eventually turned toward careers.

One relative asked,

"So...

Still unemployed?"

Jas smiled politely.

"I'm freelancing and continuing my research while searching for a full-time role."

The man laughed.

"Research?"

"Who pays you for research?"

"No one."

"Then why waste your time?"

Another relative joined in.

"You should stop dreaming."

"Take any job."

"At least people will respect you."

Jas remained calm.

His father noticed.

After everyone left, he asked,

"Why didn't you argue?"

Jas looked toward the sky.

"Because not every conversation deserves my energy."

Later that night...

He sat on the rooftop once again.

The city lights flickered beneath him.

His notebook rested on his lap.

He wrote:

Some people measure your value by your salary.

Others measure it by your title.

God measures your heart.

That gives me peace.

He closed the notebook.

A few weeks later, one of his research papers was accepted for publication on an open research platform.

There was no award.

No media attention.

No prize money.

Only a confirmation email.

Your submission has been successfully published.

Jas stared at the message.

He smiled.

His work now belonged to the world.

Somewhere...

A student might read it.

A researcher might improve it.

An engineer might build upon it.

That thought filled him with quiet satisfaction.

His mother entered the room.

"You look happy."

"I published something."

"Does that mean you got a job?"

"No."

"Then why are you smiling?"

He looked at the screen.

"Because ideas shouldn't stay inside one room."

She smiled.

"I don't understand all your work."

"But I understand your smile."

As months passed, Jas became known online among a small community of learners.

People began reading his articles.

Some emailed him with questions.

Others thanked him for sharing knowledge freely.

One engineering student wrote:

Sir, your article helped me understand a topic I struggled with for weeks. Thank you.

Jas read the message several times.

He had never met the student.

Yet his work had reached someone.

For the first time...

He realized impact didn't always require employment.

One Sunday morning, he packed his camera and rode his bicycle toward a nearby hill.

The climb was steep.

His legs ached.

Sweat covered his forehead.

Several times he considered turning back.

But he continued.

Finally...

He reached the top.

The sunrise painted the valley in shades of gold.

Clouds drifted below the hills.

Birds circled high above.

He stood silently.

"This..."

he whispered.

"This is why I never stopped."

Life wasn't only about reaching a company.

It was also about reaching moments like this.

He took a photograph.

Then another.

Then simply stood still.

Some views deserved no camera.

Only gratitude.

On the ride home, he passed a small government school.

Children were playing football barefoot.

Their laughter echoed across the playground.

One boy fell.

Another immediately helped him up.

No competition.

No ego.

Just kindness.

Jas smiled.

Some of life's greatest lessons were still taught without words.

That night, before sleeping, he wrote one final sentence in his journal.

**The road I'm walking may be slower than others.

But it is teaching me things they may never learn.**

He placed the notebook beside his bed.

Folded his hands in prayer.

"Thank You...

Not for giving me everything I asked for...

But for shaping me into someone I couldn't have become any other way."

Outside...

The wind moved gently through the trees.

Inside...

Hope had become quieter.

Stronger.

And far more difficult to break.

Chapter 9 – A Foreign Sky

"Sometimes we leave home searching for opportunities, only to discover that the greatest journey is finding ourselves."

The passport lay quietly on Jas's desk.

He picked it up and turned its pages slowly.

Fresh.

Almost empty.

Yet to him, it looked like a book waiting to be written.

For years he had dreamed of working abroad.

Not because he wanted luxury.

Not because he wanted expensive cars.

Not because he wanted to impress anyone.

He simply wanted an opportunity.

An opportunity to prove that his knowledge could solve real-world problems.

An opportunity to support his parents.

An opportunity to travel, learn, and grow.

One evening, after dinner, his father looked at him.

"So..."

"You've been applying overseas too?"

Jas nodded.

"Yes."

His father remained silent for a moment.

"It's a big decision."

"I know."

"What if it doesn't work?"

Jas smiled gently.

"What if it does?"

His father couldn't argue with that.

Months of paperwork followed.

Passport.

Documents.

Degree verification.

Medical certificates.

Résumé updates.

Online interviews.

Visa forms.

Every step demanded patience.

Every form felt like another examination.

His mother packed homemade snacks whenever he traveled to another city for document verification.

"Eat on time," she always reminded him.

He laughed.

"You've been saying that since I was five."

"And I'll keep saying it."

Finally...

An overseas interview invitation arrived.

Jas stared at the email.

He read it three times before believing it.

He whispered,

"Thank You, God."

The interview took place online.

The interviewer smiled warmly.

"So, Jas..."

"Why do you want to work here?"

He thought carefully.

"I want to contribute."

"I enjoy solving problems."

"And I want to continue learning."

The interviewer nodded.

"You've worked on independent research?"

"Yes."

"Interesting."

The conversation lasted almost an hour.

When it ended...

Jas felt hopeful.

Perhaps...

This was finally the beginning.

Weeks later...

The visa application was submitted.

Now there was nothing left to do but wait.

Waiting had become familiar.

Yet this waiting felt different.

It carried possibility.

Every morning he checked the application status.

Processing.

Processing.

Processing.

His parents prayed quietly.

Jas prayed too.

Not for success.

For peace.

One rainy afternoon, his phone rang.

The visa office.

His heartbeat quickened.

He answered immediately.

The official spoke politely.

"There is an update regarding your application."

Jas listened carefully.

"We're sorry..."

The rest of the sentence faded.

The application had not been approved.

For a long time...

He simply held the phone.

The rain outside grew heavier.

His mother noticed his expression before he spoke.

"What happened?"

He looked at her.

"It didn't work."

She placed a hand on his shoulder.

"Another opportunity will come."

Jas forced a smile.

"I know."

But inside...

He felt the weight of another dream slipping away.

That evening he walked alone through the neighborhood.

The streets were wet.

Streetlights reflected in puddles.

Children laughed as they played in the rain.

Life continued as if nothing had happened.

He entered a small temple garden nearby—not to ask questions, but to sit in silence.

He closed his eyes.

"Lord..."

"I don't understand."

"I prepared."

"I waited."

"I trusted."

"If this wasn't my path..."

"Please show me the one that is."

He remained there until sunset.

He didn't hear an answer.

But somehow...

He left feeling lighter.

The following week, another overseas opportunity appeared.

His cousin asked,

"Are you really going to apply again?"

Jas smiled.

"Yes."

"So soon?"

"If one door closes..."

"I'll knock on another."

His cousin laughed.

"You're the most stubborn person I know."

Jas grinned.

"I prefer the word persistent."

Months later...

Another interview.

Another application.

Another waiting period.

This time...

The visa was approved.

His family celebrated quietly.

His mother prepared his favorite meal.

His father hugged him.

"I always knew."

Jas smiled.

"I didn't."

Leaving India wasn't easy.

The airport was filled with emotions.

His mother adjusted his collar one last time.

His father handed him a small notebook.

"Write your journey."

Jas looked surprised.

"You've always written."

"Don't stop now."

He hugged them both.

As he walked toward immigration, he turned around several times.

His parents stood exactly where he had left them.

Smiling.

Waving.

Hiding their tears.

The airplane lifted into the night sky.

Jas looked through the window.

The city lights became tiny stars beneath the clouds.

He whispered,

"Goodbye..."

"I'll come back stronger."

A new country welcomed him with unfamiliar streets, different languages, and towering buildings.

Everything felt exciting.

Everything felt intimidating.

He rented a small shared room.

Simple.

Clean.

Enough for someone chasing a dream.

The next morning he began searching for work again.

Interview after interview.

Application after application.

Some employers appreciated his knowledge.

Others asked for local experience.

Some never replied.

Some rejected him politely.

Days became weeks.

The dream he had carried across the ocean suddenly felt fragile.

One evening he sat alone on a park bench.

The city around him buzzed with life.

Families walked together.

Friends laughed over coffee.

Cyclists passed by.

Jas opened his lunch box.

It contained simple rice his mother had taught him to cook.

He smiled.

Thousands of kilometers away...

Her recipes still felt like home.

A little girl feeding pigeons noticed him sitting alone.

She waved.

He waved back.

For a brief moment...

The loneliness faded.

That night he wrote in his journal.

I thought changing countries would change my life overnight.

Instead, I discovered that rejection speaks every language.

But so does hope.

He closed the notebook.

Looked out at the unfamiliar skyline.

The stars above were the same ones he had seen back home.

Different country.

Same sky.

Same God.

Same dream.

And the same determination to keep moving forward.

Chapter 10 – The Measure of a Man

"The world often asks, 'What do you do?' Very few ask, 'Who are you?'"

Winter arrived quietly.

The mornings were colder now.

Jas woke before sunrise, just as he always had.

He made himself a simple cup of coffee and stood beside the apartment window.

The city was already awake.

Construction workers walked toward their sites.

Office buses stopped at every corner.

People hurried through the streets with purpose.

Jas smiled.

"One day," he whispered, "I'll walk into my workplace with that same excitement."

He folded his hands.

"Lord...

Give me strength for today."

His notebook had become thicker.

Inside were interview notes.

Programming problems.

Research ideas.

Daily reflections.

Every interview taught him something new.

Every rejection taught him patience.

He no longer counted failures.

He counted lessons.

One afternoon, his brother's friend called.

"Jas, my company is hiring."

His heart skipped.

"Really?"

"Yes. Come tomorrow. I'll arrange an interview."

Jas thanked him sincerely.

That night he prepared with renewed hope.

He revised networking concepts.

Cybersecurity.

Cloud computing.

Operating systems.

Programming.

He ironed his shirt carefully.

Polished his shoes.

Before sleeping, he prayed.

"If this is Your plan, let it happen.

If not...

Help me accept it."

The office building looked impressive.

Glass walls reflected the morning sunlight.

Employees moved confidently through the lobby.

Jas took a deep breath and entered.

His brother's friend greeted him politely.

"Come, I'll introduce you."

They walked through the office.

Several employees smiled.

Some nodded.

The atmosphere felt welcoming.

Jas began to imagine himself working there.

Perhaps this was the place.

The interview panel consisted of three people.

The first interviewer smiled warmly.

"Tell us about yourself."

Jas spoke calmly.

He described his education.

His independent research.

His freelance work.

His passion for solving real-world problems.

The questions became more technical.

Programming.

Cybersecurity.

System design.

Networking.

Artificial Intelligence.

Jas answered confidently.

Occasionally he paused to think, then explained his reasoning step by step.

One interviewer nodded with appreciation.

Another wrote notes continuously.

When the interview ended, one of them smiled.

"Thank you, Jas."

"You clearly enjoy learning."

Jas left the room feeling hopeful.

Outside, he waited.

Minutes passed.

Then an hour.

Finally, his brother's friend returned.

"I'm sorry."

"They've chosen another candidate."

Jas nodded politely.

"I understand."

As he stood to leave, he overheard two employees discussing the new hire.

"He already had experience with our systems."

Jas smiled to himself.

That explanation hurt less than uncertainty.

Sometimes another candidate is simply a better fit.

He accepted it and walked out with his head held high.

The bus ride home felt unusually long.

He chose a seat by the window.

Rain tapped gently against the glass.

A woman carrying groceries sat across the aisle.

A college student revised notes for an exam.

A father held his sleeping daughter close.

Life continued.

Jas looked outside.

The city blurred beneath the rain.

He whispered,

"I gave my best."

"And tomorrow..."

"I'll give my best again."

A few weeks later, relatives gathered for a family celebration.

As always, introductions began.

"This is my son."

"She's a doctor."

"He's an engineer."

"This is my daughter. She works in finance."

Then someone pointed toward Jas.

"And this is..."

There was a brief pause.

"He's still searching for a job."

The conversation moved on.

Nobody intended to be cruel.

Yet the words lingered.

For a moment, Jas felt as though years of effort had been reduced to a single sentence.

Still searching.

That evening, he walked alone through a nearby park.

The cool breeze carried the scent of flowering trees.

Children laughed on the swings.

An elderly man fed birds.

Jas sat on a wooden bench.

He asked himself,

"If people describe me only by what I don't have...

Who am I?"

He opened his notebook.

After several minutes, he wrote:

I am not my job title.

I am not my salary.

I am not the number of rejection emails in my inbox.

I am a son.

A learner.

A researcher.

A writer.

A traveler.

A man who refuses to stop trying.

He closed the notebook and smiled.

That page became one of his favorites.

Months passed.

Freelance work continued.

Research papers slowly reached readers.

He received occasional emails from students.

One message read:

Sir, thank you for sharing your work. It inspired me to start my own project.

Jas read it twice.

No company had called him an employee.

Yet somewhere, someone called him an inspiration.

Perhaps...

That mattered too.

One evening, he stood on the rooftop of his apartment.

The foreign skyline glittered beneath the stars.

He remembered the gold medal in his parents' house.

He remembered every interview.

Every rejection.

Every train journey.

Every prayer.

He realized something.

Success wasn't arriving all at once.

It was quietly shaping him through every disappointment.

He looked toward the night sky.

"Lord...

If this journey is preparing me for something greater...

Then keep preparing me.

Just don't let me lose kindness along the way."

A cool wind crossed the rooftop.

He smiled.

For the first time in years...

He wasn't chasing a title.

He was becoming the kind of man who would honor any title he eventually received.

And somehow...

That felt like progress.

Chapter 11 – A Dream Beyond Employment

"Some people dream of finding a job. Others dream of finding their purpose. Jas wanted both—but if he had to choose, he would never abandon his purpose."

The years had passed more quickly than Jas realized.

His inbox had become a museum of polite disappointments.

Every rejection email looked almost identical.

Every company thanked him for his interest.

Every company wished him success.

Very few gave him an opportunity.

One evening, while cleaning his laptop, he noticed something unusual.

His email storage was almost full.

He opened the statistics.

Nearly eight gigabytes of storage had been used.

Curious, he searched one word.

"Unfortunately."

Hundreds of emails appeared.

Jas laughed quietly.

"If disappointment had a favorite word..."

he whispered,

"...this would be it."

He closed the laptop.

For the first time, he wasn't angry.

He simply smiled.

Those emails no longer represented failure.

They represented persistence.

The following morning, he visited a nearby hill before sunrise.

The air was cold.

Mist floated gently over the valley.

Birds welcomed the morning with songs that echoed through the forest.

Jas carried only his backpack, camera, notebook, and a bottle of water.

He climbed slowly.

Each step reminded him of his journey.

Nothing meaningful had ever been easy.

When he finally reached the summit, the horizon exploded into shades of orange and gold.

The first rays of sunlight touched the earth.

Jas stood silently.

No phone.

No interview.

No expectations.

Only peace.

He closed his eyes.

"Thank You, Lord."

"Not because life became easier."

"But because You never let me stop believing."

As he sat on a large rock overlooking the valley, another traveler approached.

An elderly man carrying a walking stick smiled politely.

"Beautiful view."

Jas nodded.

"It makes problems look smaller."

The old man laughed.

"Or perhaps it reminds us how small we are."

They sat together for several minutes.

Eventually the man asked,

"What do you do?"

Jas smiled.

It was the question he had answered hundreds of times.

This time...

His answer was different.

"I research."

"I write."

"I build software."

"And I'm searching for a full-time opportunity."

The old man looked surprised.

"You didn't say you were unemployed."

Jas smiled.

"Because that's only part of the story."

The man nodded with admiration.

"I like that."

Before leaving, he turned back.

"Never introduce yourself by what you're missing."

"Introduce yourself by what you're becoming."

Those words stayed with Jas long after the man disappeared down the trail.

Back home, he opened his notebook.

On a fresh page he wrote:

I am not waiting for life to begin.

I am already living it.

He underlined the sentence twice.

The following weeks became some of the busiest of his life.

During the day, he completed freelance assignments.

At night, he continued writing research papers.

He explored topics that fascinated him.

Healthcare technology.

Cybersecurity.

Artificial intelligence.

Space communication.

Sustainable aviation.

Disaster management.

Friends often asked,

"Why so many different fields?"

Jas smiled.

"Problems don't stay inside one subject."

"If knowledge can help people..."

"I want to learn it."

One afternoon, he submitted another research paper to an international conference.

The paper wasn't guaranteed acceptance.

Still...

He pressed **Submit**.

Then he prayed.

"If it reaches the right people..."

Thank You.

If it doesn't...

Teach me something through the process."

Several weeks later...

An email arrived.

This time...

It wasn't a rejection.

It was an acknowledgment.

The organizers appreciated the idea and encouraged him to continue developing it, even though it wasn't selected for presentation that year.

Jas smiled.

For someone who had grown used to reading only "Unfortunately..."

those few encouraging sentences felt like sunlight after a long monsoon.

That evening his mother called.

"How was your day?"

"Good."

"Interview?"

"No."

"Research."

She laughed.

"You sound happier talking about research than interviews."

"I am."

"But I still need a job."

"I know."

She paused.

"Just don't lose that smile."

"I'll try."

A few days later, Jas visited a government library.

The building was old.

Dust covered many of the shelves.

Yet inside those shelves rested thousands of dreams written by people who had lived before him.

Scientists.

Engineers.

Explorers.

Novelists.

Astronauts.

Inventors.

He wandered through the aisles for hours.

Finally, he found the autobiography of a famous scientist.

One sentence caught his attention.

"Success belongs to those who continue working after everyone else stops believing."

Jas closed the book gently.

"I understand that now."

That night he made a decision.

He opened a new folder on his laptop.

Its name was simple.

Books

Inside he created another folder.

Beyond the Rejection

He smiled.

Perhaps...

If companies didn't know his story...

Readers someday would.

Not to gain sympathy.

But to remind another young graduate somewhere in the world that rejection isn't the end of a dream.

Sometimes...

It's the beginning of a different one.

The rain began outside.

Jas moved his chair closer to the window.

He opened a blank page.

Placed his fingers on the keyboard.

Then typed the first line.

"Success is celebrated for a day. The journey behind it lasts a lifetime."

He smiled.

The sentence felt familiar.

Because it was true.

Before sleeping, he wrote one final entry in his journal.

The world may remember me for the job I eventually get.

But I hope God remembers me for never giving up before I got there.

He closed the notebook.

Turned off the light.

Outside...

The rain continued.

Inside...

A new dream had quietly begun.

Not just to find a career.

But to leave behind something that could inspire others long after his own journey was over.

Chapter 12 – When Dreams Travel Without You

"Sometimes your ideas reach places your feet cannot."

The rain had stopped.

Sunlight streamed through the window, falling across Jas's desk. Books lay open beside his laptop. Engineering journals were stacked neatly on one side, while notebooks filled with sketches and ideas occupied the other.

His room had become more than a bedroom.

It had become his laboratory.

Not because of expensive equipment.

But because every corner contained curiosity.

One morning, while browsing the internet, Jas discovered an international conference inviting researchers to submit papers on future technologies.

His eyes widened.

Participants from universities around the world.

Scientists.

Professors.

Industry experts.

Students.

It felt impossible.

He wasn't from a famous laboratory.

He wasn't backed by a university.

He had no funding.

Only an idea.

He closed his eyes for a moment.

Then smiled.

"An idea doesn't know who wrote it."

For the next month, he worked harder than ever.

His daily routine became almost military.

5:30 AM

Wake up.

Prayer.

Morning walk.

Breakfast.

7:00 AM

Read research papers.

Study recent technological developments.

10:00 AM

Freelance work.

2:00 PM

Lunch.

3:00 PM

Continue writing the research paper.

7:00 PM

Dinner with family.

8:00 PM until midnight

Editing.

Proofreading.

Reading references.

Checking every sentence.

Checking every figure.

Checking every citation.

Again.

And again.

His mother often entered his room carrying tea.

"You'll become sick if you don't rest."

Jas smiled.

"I'll rest after finishing."

"You've been saying that for three weeks."

"I know."

She laughed.

"I should stop believing you."

One evening his father entered quietly.

He watched Jas working.

"What are you changing now?"

"The conclusion."

"Weren't you changing the conclusion yesterday?"

"I found a better way to explain it."

His father shook his head.

"Perfectionist."

Jas smiled.

"No."

"I just don't want to regret not giving my best."

Finally...

The paper was ready.

Thirty-two pages.

Months of research.

Hundreds of references.

Countless revisions.

Jas stared at the **Submit** button.

He remembered every rejection.

Every interview.

Every disappointment.

Then he remembered every prayer.

He folded his hands.

"Lord...

This paper belongs to You now.

Whatever happens...

'Thank You.'

Click.

The paper disappeared into cyberspace.

The waiting began.

Again.

But this waiting felt different.

He wasn't waiting for a salary.

He was waiting to see whether his ideas mattered.

Weeks passed.

Every morning he checked his email.

Nothing.

Then...

One afternoon...

A notification appeared.

Conference Committee

His heart raced.

He opened it.

The first sentence thanked him.

The second congratulated him.

His eyes widened.

The paper had been accepted for presentation.

He couldn't believe it.

He read the email three times.

Then ran into the living room.

"Amma!"

His mother looked up.

"What happened?"

"It was accepted!"

She didn't understand every detail.

But she understood his smile.

She hugged him tightly.

His father smiled quietly.

"I'm proud of you."

The conference would be held in another country.

For the first time...

Jas imagined himself standing before researchers from around the world.

Sharing an idea born inside his tiny bedroom.

He began preparing immediately.

Presentation slides.

Speaking practice.

Questions the audience might ask.

Everything.

Then reality arrived.

Travel expenses.

Registration fees.

Accommodation.

Visa.

Transportation.

The numbers kept growing.

Far beyond what he could afford.

He stared silently at the screen.

His excitement slowly faded.

That evening he sat alone on the rooftop.

The acceptance letter rested beside him.

The city lights flickered below.

He whispered,

"So close..."

"But still so far."

His father joined him.

"You've been quiet."

Jas handed him the email.

His father read it slowly.

"You got accepted."

"Yes."

"Then why aren't you happy?"

"I can't afford to go."

His father remained silent.

After several moments he spoke.

"Listen."

"When I was young..."

"I couldn't even dream this far."

"You already have."

"Whether you stand on that stage or not..."

"Your work reached them."

Jas looked toward the stars.

Maybe...

His father was right.

The next morning he emailed the organizers.

He explained his situation honestly.

A few days later they replied.

Although they couldn't cover all expenses, they encouraged him to continue his research and invited him to participate remotely if possible.

Jas smiled.

His dream hadn't ended.

It had simply changed form.

Weeks later...

The day of the conference arrived.

He dressed neatly.

Set up his laptop.

Adjusted the webcam.

As researchers from different countries joined the virtual session, Jas felt both nervous and grateful.

When his turn came, he spoke clearly.

Not as someone representing a famous institution.

But as someone representing perseverance.

He spoke about solving problems.

Learning continuously.

Building ideas with limited resources.

When he finished...

The moderator smiled.

"Thank you, Jas."

"Your passion is evident."

Several attendees asked thoughtful questions.

One professor concluded,

"Keep researching."

"The world needs people who remain curious."

Those words stayed with him.

That evening, after the session ended, Jas stepped outside.

The sky glowed with the colors of sunset.

A gentle breeze moved through the trees.

He smiled.

Years earlier...

He had believed success meant getting a job offer.

Today...

He realized something different.

Sometimes success meant being heard.

Sometimes success meant inspiring one person.

Sometimes success meant refusing to let circumstances silence your ideas.

Back in his room, he opened his journal.

He wrote:

My body remained at home.

But my dreams crossed oceans today.

No rejection can stop an idea once it begins traveling through people's minds.

He closed the notebook.

Looked toward the evening sky.

Somewhere beyond the horizon...

People he had never met now knew his name.

Not because of a job title.

Not because of a salary.

But because he had chosen to keep creating when it would have been easier to quit.

He smiled.

Perhaps...

This was only the beginning.

Chapter 13 – The Book That Saved Its Author

"Some books are written to change the world. Others are written because they save the person writing them."

The night was unusually quiet.

A gentle breeze drifted through the half-open window of Jas's room, carrying the scent of wet earth after an evening rain. His desk lamp was the only light still glowing in the house.

The digital clock read **2:17 A.M.**

Everyone else was asleep.

But Jas wasn't.

Sleep had become a stranger.

For years, he had tried to force himself into a normal routine.

He had tried sleeping early.

Drinking warm milk.

Listening to calming music.

Even medication prescribed to help him sleep.

Nothing worked.

No matter what he tried, his mind refused to rest before dawn.

Most nights, he finally fell asleep around six in the morning.

Sometimes later.

His body had adapted.

His dreams had not.

He walked toward the window.

The street outside was empty.

Only a lonely streetlight illuminated the road.

He looked at the sky.

Thousands of stars shimmered above him.

He whispered,

"Lord...

Everyone sleeps peacefully.

Why can't I?"

Silence answered.

But somehow...

That silence felt comforting.

He had spoken to God so many times over the years that silence no longer frightened him.

Sometimes...

Silence was simply another language of faith.

His laptop chimed.

Another email.

Without excitement, he opened it.

Dear Applicant...

Unfortunately...

He smiled.

Not because it was funny.

Because it had become familiar.

He archived the email.

Then opened another folder.

It contained hundreds of similar messages.

Different companies.

Different countries.

Different years.

The same ending.

He leaned back in his chair.

"If someone counted these..."

he murmured,

"they'd think my life was full of failure."

He paused.

"But they wouldn't see everything I learned between each rejection."

He opened a blank document.

The cursor blinked patiently.

Waiting.

Jas stared at the empty page.

"What should I write?"

For a long time...

Nothing came.

Then...

He remembered the train journey.

The mountain sunrise.

The interviews.

His parents.

His hostel friends.

The little victories no résumé could describe.

He placed his fingers on the keyboard.

Words began to appear.

Not perfectly.

Not quickly.

But honestly.

The first sentence read:

****"Rejection is not the opposite of success.**

Sometimes it is the road that leads there."******

He smiled.

Something inside him felt lighter.

He continued writing.

Page after page.

Hour after hour.

The night disappeared unnoticed.

The following morning his mother knocked gently on the door.

"Jas?"

No answer.

She opened the door quietly.

There he was.

Asleep at the desk.

The laptop still open.

Pages filled with words.

She smiled softly.

Instead of waking him...

She covered him with a blanket.

Before leaving the room, she looked at the screen.

She didn't read every page.

Only the title.

Beyond the Rejection

She whispered,

"I hope the world reads your heart one day."

Days became weeks.

Writing slowly became therapy.

Whenever disappointment overwhelmed him...

He wrote.

Whenever someone questioned his future...

He wrote.

Whenever loneliness became too heavy...

He wrote.

His notebook filled with stories.

Conversations.

Dreams.

Thoughts.

Faith.

Nature.

Hope.

He wasn't trying to become famous.

He was trying to stay alive emotionally.

One afternoon, while sitting in a small café, a college student noticed the notebook beside him.

"Excuse me..."

Jas looked up.

"Are you a writer?"

He laughed.

"I don't know yet."

The student smiled.

"You've been writing for two hours."

Jas looked at the notebook.

"Maybe I'm just trying to understand life."

The student nodded.

"That's what writers do."

That evening he returned home inspired.

He searched online.

How to publish a book.

How to format a manuscript.

How to design a cover.

How authors tell stories.

The more he learned...

The more impossible it seemed.

Thousands of books were published every day.

Why would anyone read his?

The thought discouraged him.

Until another thought arrived.

He remembered something his father had once said.

**"If you help even one person...

Your effort wasn't wasted."**

One reader.

Just one.

That was enough.

Months later...

His manuscript slowly took shape.

It wasn't perfect.

There were spelling mistakes.

Paragraphs rewritten dozens of times.

Entire chapters deleted and started again.

Still...

He continued.

Every page carried a piece of his heart.

One rainy evening, he showed the first chapter to his father.

His father adjusted his glasses.

Read silently.

Then closed the pages.

Jas waited nervously.

"So..."

"What do you think?"

His father smiled.

"I don't understand every technical word."

Jas laughed.

"But..."

His father continued,

"I understand one thing."

"What?"

"You never stopped believing."

He handed the manuscript back.

"Don't stop now."

Weeks later...

Jas reached the final page.

He typed two words.

The End.

He stared at them for several minutes.

Then quietly closed his laptop.

No applause.

No celebration.

No audience.

Only silence.

But this silence felt different.

This silence carried fulfillment.

That night...

He climbed onto the rooftop.

The moon hung high above the city.

He looked toward the stars.

"Lord..."

"I asked You for a career."

"You gave me patience."

"I asked You for success."

"You taught me perseverance."

"I asked You for opportunity."

"You showed me purpose."

A tear rolled down his cheek.

Not from sadness.

From gratitude.

Before going to bed, he opened his journal one final time that night.

He wrote:

Maybe this book will never become famous.

Maybe only a few people will read it.

But if one person decides not to give up because of these pages...

Then every rejection I experienced was worth something.

He closed the journal.

Switched off the light.

Outside...

The city slept peacefully.

Inside...

A writer had quietly been born.

Chapter 14 – The Climb

"Mountains don't care who you are. They don't ask about your salary, your failures, or your title. They only ask one question: Will you keep climbing?"

The first mountain Jas climbed was not the tallest.

It wasn't famous.

There were no tourists waiting to take photographs.

No souvenir shops.

No crowds.

Just a narrow trail disappearing into the forest.

For most people, it was simply another hill.

For Jas...

It became a classroom.

He reached the base just before sunrise.

The air was cool.

Mist covered the trees like a soft blanket.

Birds greeted the morning with songs hidden among the branches.

He tightened the straps of his backpack.

Inside were simple things.

A bottle of water.

A notebook.

His camera.

A light jacket.

Nothing expensive.

Nothing unnecessary.

He smiled.

"Let's begin."

The first few kilometers felt easy.

The trail was wide.

The ground was almost flat.

He walked confidently.

"This isn't difficult," he thought.

Life had taught him that lesson before.

The beginning of every journey feels easier than the middle.

As the sun climbed higher, the trail changed.

The road became steeper.

Loose rocks covered the path.

Roots stretched across the ground like natural staircases.

Every step demanded attention.

His breathing became heavier.

Sweat covered his forehead.

He stopped.

Looked back.

The valley below looked beautiful.

The town had become tiny.

The people...

The buildings...

The traffic...

Everything seemed so small.

He realized something.

The higher you climb...

The smaller your worries begin to look.

He continued.

One step.

Another step.

Then another.

There was no shortcut.

No elevator.

No miracle.

Only patience.

About halfway up the mountain, he met an elderly man carrying a wooden walking stick.

The man looked at him and smiled.

"First time?"

Jas nodded.

"Yes."

The old man chuckled.

"I could tell."

"How?"

"You're looking at the summit."

"You should look at the next step."

Jas laughed.

"What do you mean?"

The old man tapped his walking stick against the ground.

"If you keep staring at the top..."

"You'll become tired."

"If you focus on the next step..."

"You'll eventually reach the top without realizing it."

The man continued climbing.

His words stayed behind.

Jas looked toward the summit again.

It still looked impossibly far away.

Then he lowered his eyes.

One step.

Just one.

Then another.

The climb suddenly felt easier.

Not because the mountain changed.

Because his perspective changed.

Hours later, clouds surrounded the trail.

Visibility dropped.

The wind became stronger.

He couldn't see the summit anymore.

Only the path beneath his feet.

For a moment, doubt entered his mind.

"What if I'm going the wrong way?"

"What if I never reach the top?"

Then another thought answered.

"You don't always need to see the destination."

"You only need to trust the path."

He smiled.

Life felt exactly the same.

When he finally reached the summit...

There was no crowd waiting.

No music.

No celebration.

Only silence.

Beautiful...

Peaceful...

Powerful silence.

The clouds slowly drifted below him.

The mountains stretched endlessly toward the horizon.

Sunlight broke through the mist like golden rivers across the sky.

Jas stood motionless.

His heart filled with gratitude.

Not because he had conquered the mountain.

Because the mountain had changed him.

He sat on a large rock overlooking the valley.

The cool wind touched his face.

He opened his notebook.

For several minutes, he simply watched the world below.

Then he wrote.

Life isn't about reaching the highest mountain.

It's about becoming stronger with every climb.

A family soon reached the summit.

A little boy looked exhausted.

"I can't walk anymore," he complained.

His father smiled.

"You already did."

The boy looked confused.

"No, I didn't."

The father pointed behind them.

"Look."

The child turned around.

The valley stretched far below.

His eyes widened.

"We came all the way from there?"

"Yes."

The boy smiled proudly.

"I didn't know."

Jas smiled quietly.

How often had he forgotten to look back?

He always focused on how far he still had to go.

Rarely on how far he had already come.

He spent hours taking photographs.

The mountains.

The clouds.

Wildflowers growing between rocks.

A lone eagle circling overhead.

Every picture reminded him that beauty often exists where the climb is hardest.

Before leaving, he folded his hands.

"Lord...

Thank You for this mountain."

"It reminded me that every difficult path has a beautiful view."

The journey down proved different.

His legs were tired.

The rocks felt slippery.

He walked more carefully.

Success, he realized, also required humility.

Many people reached the top.

Some forgot they still had to come down safely.

Life was the same.

Titles.

Money.

Recognition.

None of them mattered if they made a person arrogant.

Back home, his mother noticed the dirt on his shoes.

"You climbed again?"

Jas laughed.

"Yes."

"Were you tired?"

"Very."

"So why do you keep going?"

He thought for a moment.

"Because every mountain teaches me something no classroom ever could."

She smiled.

"I don't understand mountains."

"I understand your smile after climbing them."

That evening he uploaded a photograph from the summit.

The caption was simple.

"Keep climbing. Even when the summit disappears behind the clouds."

Within hours, dozens of people liked the post.

Some commented on the beautiful scenery.

Others asked where the mountain was.

One message stood out.

A young engineering student wrote:

Sir, I was feeling like giving up after many job rejections. Your caption gave me hope today. Thank you.

Jas read the message twice.

He smiled.

Maybe...

The climb wasn't only for him.

Maybe every step he took could encourage someone else to keep walking.

That night, before sleeping, he opened his journal.

On a fresh page he wrote his biggest dream.

One day...

I will stand at the foot of Mount Everest.

Whether I reach the summit or not...

I want to honor the dream by trying.

He underlined the last sentence.

Dreams, he believed, were not promises.

They were directions.

As he closed the notebook, he looked once more through his window.

Far beyond the city lights...

Beyond the hills...

Beyond the clouds...

Higher mountains waited.

And somewhere beyond those mountains...

So did his future.

He smiled.

Tomorrow would bring more applications.

More interviews.

Perhaps more rejection.

But it would also bring another sunrise.

Another opportunity.

Another step.

And sometimes...

One step is enough.

Chapter 15 – The Interview That Changed Nothing... and Everything

"Not every interview gives you a job. Some interviews give you a stronger version of yourself."

The alarm rang at 5:00 a.m.

Jas was already awake.

He had barely slept.

Not because he was anxious.

Because years of job searching had trained his mind to wake before every interview.

He switched off the alarm, folded his blanket neatly, and walked toward the window.

The first light of dawn slowly painted the sky.

Another interview.

Another opportunity.

Another unknown ending.

He closed his eyes.

"Lord...

If today is my day, thank You.

If not...

Help me leave this place with my dignity."

His laptop bag rested beside the door.

Inside were copies of his résumé.

Certificates.

Research papers.

A notebook.

A pen.

Nothing extraordinary.

Just years of hard work compressed into a folder.

His mother handed him breakfast.

"You should eat."

"I'm not hungry."

"You never are before interviews."

He smiled.

She placed her hand on his head.

"I don't know whether they'll choose you."

"But I know one thing."

"What?"

"You've never stopped trying."

The office stood in the center of the city's technology district.

Tall glass buildings reflected the morning sun.

Young professionals walked confidently through the entrance wearing company ID cards.

Jas watched them for a moment.

He imagined himself among them.

Not for status.

For purpose.

The reception area was crowded.

Nearly forty candidates waited quietly.

Some revised technical notes.

Others practiced interview questions.

A few stared nervously at the floor.

Jas smiled.

Everyone carried invisible stories.

No one knew how much another person had sacrificed just to be sitting in that waiting room.

A young man sitting beside him broke the silence.

"First interview?"

Jas laughed softly.

"I've lost count."

The man smiled.

"I'm Rahul."

"Jas."

Rahul sighed.

"I've been rejected five times."

Jas looked at him kindly.

"I've crossed a hundred."

Rahul stared at him.

"You still smile?"

Jas nodded.

"If I lose my smile..."

"I'll lose more than a job."

Rahul smiled for the first time that morning.

Hours later, Jas's name echoed through the hallway.

"Mr. Jas."

He stood.

Adjusted his tie.

Walked into the interview room.

Three interviewers greeted him.

The first introduced herself.

"Please make yourself comfortable."

He thanked them and sat down.

The questions began.

Programming.

Algorithms.

Cybersecurity.

Networking.

Cloud computing.

Database optimization.

Artificial Intelligence.

System architecture.

Each question reminded him of the countless nights he had spent studying.

Whenever he didn't know something completely, he admitted it honestly.

"I haven't worked on that directly."

"But here's how I would approach it."

The panel appreciated his reasoning.

One interviewer smiled repeatedly.

Another kept writing notes.

The conversation lasted nearly ninety minutes.

It felt less like an interview...

More like a discussion between engineers.

Finally, the senior interviewer leaned forward.

"Jas..."

"We've noticed something unusual."

He waited.

"You've worked independently across healthcare, aerospace, cybersecurity, and software."

"Why?"

Jas smiled.

"Because problems don't choose only one field."

"If learning another subject helps me solve a real-world problem..."

"I'll learn it."

The interviewer nodded slowly.

"I like your curiosity."

As the interview ended, one interviewer said,

"No matter what happens today..."

"Please continue your research."

"We need people who think this way."

Jas thanked them sincerely.

For the first time in years...

He walked out without regret.

Whether selected or not...

He had represented himself honestly.

Three days later...

The familiar email arrived.

His heartbeat remained calm.

He opened it.

Dear Jas,

Thank you for attending the interview...

After careful consideration...

We regret to inform you...

He smiled.

Closed the laptop.

Walked outside.

The rejection still hurt.

But not as deeply as before.

Because he had learned something.

His worth had not changed between the interview and the email.

Only the company's decision had.

That evening Rahul called him.

"Did you get it?"

"No."

"You?"

"No."

Both laughed.

Rahul sighed.

"I don't know what to do anymore."

Jas remained silent for a moment.

Then said,

"Take tomorrow off."

"What?"

"Go somewhere."

"A beach."

"A park."

"A mountain."

"Anywhere."

"Don't spend tomorrow believing you're a failure."

Rahul asked quietly,

"How do you stay positive?"

Jas looked toward the evening sky.

"I don't stay positive every day."

"I just refuse to stay hopeless."

A week later, Rahul sent him a message.

Thank you. I went trekking. I came back feeling alive again.

Jas smiled.

Sometimes encouragement traveled farther than advice.

That weekend, Jas visited an orphanage near his hometown.

Not because it was a special occasion.

Simply because he wanted to spend time somewhere filled with genuine smiles.

The children welcomed him warmly.

They didn't ask,

"What package do you earn?"

"What company do you work for?"

"What is your job title?"

Instead they asked,

"Will you play football with us?"

"Can you tell us a story?"

"Will you eat lunch with us?"

For three hours...

Jas forgot every rejection email.

He laughed.

Ran.

Played.

Shared meals.

Read stories.

Before leaving, a little boy hugged him tightly.

"When will you come back?"

Jas smiled.

"Soon."

As he walked away, he realized something.

Those children had made him feel valuable without knowing anything about his career.

That night he opened his journal.

He wrote:

The interview didn't change my life.

But the people I met afterward did.

Sometimes the greatest success isn't receiving an offer letter.

It's becoming someone who can still encourage others while carrying their own disappointments.

He closed the notebook.

Looked through the window.

The stars shone brightly above.

Tomorrow another application would be sent.

Another interview would eventually come.

Another decision would be made.

But tonight...

He was at peace.

Because he had discovered something no company could ever offer him.

A purpose bigger than employment.

Chapter 16 – The Letter He Never Sent

"Some words are never spoken aloud. They live quietly in journals, prayers, and hearts that refuse to stop caring."

Years had passed since Jas had begun searching for his place in the world.

His résumé had grown.

His research portfolio had expanded.

His books had slowly found readers.

His knowledge had deepened.

Yet one question remained the same.

"When will my career truly begin?"

He no longer asked it with frustration.

He asked it with patience.

Because life had taught him that every season had its own purpose.

One rainy afternoon, Jas sat in a small café near the railway station.

Rainwater rolled down the windows while travelers hurried toward departing trains.

He ordered a cup of tea.

Opened his notebook.

And simply watched people.

A young couple laughed while sharing an umbrella.

An elderly man waited patiently with a walking stick.

A little girl hugged her father before boarding a train.

Everyone seemed to be traveling somewhere.

Jas wondered if life itself was just another long journey between stations.

His phone vibrated.

Another interview invitation.

He smiled.

Even after years of rejection...

Hope still arrived in the form of an email.

He accepted the invitation and prepared once again.

Not because he expected success.

But because giving up had never become an option.

The interview was held online.

The recruiter greeted him warmly.

"Good morning, Jas."

"Good morning."

The conversation flowed naturally.

They discussed software development.

Cybersecurity.

Research.

Freelancing.

Photography.

Even travel.

Near the end, the recruiter asked,

"I've noticed something unusual."

Jas smiled.

"What is it?"

"You've stayed productive even without full-time employment."

"Most people stop learning."

"You didn't."

Jas thought for a moment.

Then answered honestly.

"I couldn't control whether someone hired me."

"But I could control whether I kept growing."

The recruiter smiled.

"I hope you never lose that mindset."

Days later...

The result arrived.

Another rejection.

This time the email included a personal note.

We were impressed by your passion and curiosity. We encourage you to continue your journey and apply again in the future.

Jas smiled.

Years ago, such words would have broken his heart.

Now...

They reminded him that progress wasn't always measured by offer letters.

Sometimes...

People remembered your character even when they couldn't hire you.

That evening he boarded a train without any destination in mind.

He bought the cheapest ticket available.

Found a window seat.

And let the railway decide the route.

The rhythmic sound of the train calmed him.

Outside...

Green fields stretched endlessly.

Children waved from village crossings.

Farmers worked beneath the evening sun.

Life felt beautifully ordinary.

Across from him sat a university student reading a thick engineering textbook.

After several minutes, the student looked up.

"Excuse me, sir."

Jas smiled.

"Yes?"

"I've seen your research articles online."

Jas blinked in surprise.

"You have?"

The student nodded enthusiastically.

"They helped me with my final-year project."

"I wanted to thank you."

For a moment...

Jas couldn't speak.

A stranger.

On a random train.

Had recognized his work.

Not because of a company.

Not because of fame.

Because knowledge had quietly traveled farther than he ever imagined.

The student asked,

"Can I ask you something?"

"Of course."

"Were you always successful?"

Jas laughed softly.

"No."

"I've simply failed longer than most people are willing to."

The student looked confused.

"So why didn't you stop?"

Jas looked out the window.

"Because every time I thought about quitting..."

"I remembered someone who might someday need what I was learning."

The student smiled.

"I hope I become like that."

Jas shook his head gently.

"No."

"Become a better version."

That night, after returning home, Jas opened his old email folder.

Hundreds of rejection messages still remained.

He considered deleting them.

His finger rested above the keyboard.

Then he stopped.

"No."

"They're part of my story."

Instead of deleting them...

He created a new folder.

Its name was simple.

Lessons.

Every rejection email went inside it.

Not as reminders of failure.

But as reminders of perseverance.

Before sleeping, Jas found an old notebook hidden inside a drawer.

The pages had turned slightly yellow with time.

Inside were dreams he had written years earlier.

Become an Aerospace Scientist.

Publish research.

Write books.

Travel the world.

Support my parents.

Climb Mount Everest.

He smiled.

Some dreams had begun.

Others still waited.

None had disappeared.

He turned to a blank page.

For reasons he couldn't explain...

He began writing a letter.

Not to a company.

Not to a recruiter.

Not even to himself.

The letter began with one sentence.

Dear Future...

He continued writing.

I don't know where you'll find me.

Maybe inside a research laboratory.

Maybe inside a small office.

Maybe standing on a mountain.

Maybe writing another book.

Or maybe still searching.

Wherever I am...

I hope I never become proud.

I hope I never forget the people who encouraged me when nobody else believed in me.

I hope I never measure another person's worth by their salary.

And I hope I never stop learning.

He read the letter once.

Folded it carefully.

Placed it inside his notebook.

He never mailed it.

It wasn't meant for anyone else.

It was a promise to himself.

Before turning off the light, he whispered a quiet prayer.

"Lord...

I still don't know where this road ends.

But I know Who walks beside me."

Outside, the night sky stretched endlessly above the quiet town.

The stars looked exactly as they had years before.

Constant.

Faithful.

Patient.

Jas smiled.

Perhaps...

He wasn't waiting for life anymore.

Perhaps life had been shaping him all along.

He closed his eyes.

Tomorrow would bring another sunrise.

Another application.

Another opportunity to learn.

And another chance to keep moving forward.

Because hope...

Had become his way of living.

Chapter 17 – The Door That Finally Opened

"Years of rejection don't disappear the day success arrives. They become the foundation beneath it."

The morning began like every other.

Jas woke before sunrise.

He made himself a cup of coffee.

Opened his laptop.

Logged into three different job portals.

The routine had become part of his life.

Search.

Apply.

Update résumé.

Check emails.

Repeat.

There was nothing glamorous about chasing a dream.

It was mostly repetition.

His inbox contained six new emails.

Five began with familiar words.

"Thank you for your interest..."

He smiled.

Archived them without reading further.

The sixth email was different.

The subject read:

Interview Invitation – Research and Innovation Division

He stopped.

Read it again.

A research division.

Not a regular software job.

Not a support role.

Research.

His heartbeat quickened.

The position combined several fields.

Software engineering.

Artificial Intelligence.

Cybersecurity.

Data analysis.

Innovation.

For the first time...

He wasn't reading a job description and thinking,

"I fit only part of this."

Instead, he smiled.

"This feels like me."

The interview was scheduled two weeks later.

Unlike previous interviews...

He didn't prepare by memorizing answers.

He prepared by revisiting everything he had built over the years.

Research papers.

Open-source projects.

Technical articles.

Algorithms.

Photography.

Books.

Travel journals.

Everything.

He realized something.

Nothing he had created was wasted.

Every project had quietly prepared him for this moment.

The interview day arrived.

Instead of asking,

"What programming languages do you know?"

The panel asked,

"What problem would you like to solve if resources were unlimited?"

Jas smiled.

For the first time...

Someone wanted to know how he thought.

He spoke about affordable healthcare technology.

Cybersecurity awareness.

Sustainable aviation.

Disaster response systems.

Using Artificial Intelligence responsibly.

Space technology for humanity.

The room remained silent.

Not because they disagreed.

Because they listened carefully.

One interviewer leaned forward.

"Most candidates answer only what we ask."

"You answer what the future might ask."

Jas smiled nervously.

"I've had a lot of time to think."

Everyone laughed.

The interview lasted nearly three hours.

When it ended...

The chairperson stood up.

"Thank you, Jas."

"No matter what the outcome..."

"Please continue researching."

The words felt sincere.

Walking out of the building, Jas noticed something unusual.

He wasn't wondering whether he would be selected.

He was simply grateful that someone had finally understood him.

For years...

People had seen scattered interests.

Today...

Someone saw a connected vision.

A week passed.

Then another.

The waiting returned.

But this waiting felt peaceful.

He spent the days finishing freelance projects.

Reading.

Writing.

Cycling.

Helping students online.

Life no longer stopped because of one application.

One evening, while photographing a sunset near a lake, his phone rang.

Unknown number.

"Hello?"

"May I speak with Mr. Jas?"

"Speaking."

"This is from the Research and Innovation Division."

His heart stood still.

"We're pleased to inform you..."

Everything after that sentence became a blur.

He had been selected.

For several seconds...

He couldn't speak.

The recruiter laughed gently.

"Mr. Jas?"

"Are you still there?"

A tear rolled down his cheek.

"Yes..."

"I'm here."

"Thank you."

He ended the call.

Looked toward the sky.

The sunset painted the lake with shades of gold.

He folded his hands.

Not asking for anything.

Simply saying,

"Thank You."

When he reached home...

His parents were sitting in the living room.

His mother looked up immediately.

"What happened?"

Jas smiled.

A smile they had waited years to see.

"I got the job."

Silence.

Then his mother covered her face as tears filled her eyes.

His father stood slowly.

Walked toward him.

Placed both hands on his shoulders.

"I knew this day would come."

Jas shook his head.

"I didn't."

His father hugged him tightly.

Neither of them spoke.

Words were unnecessary.

That night...

Messages poured in.

Congratulations.

Best wishes.

Celebrations.

Many people suddenly remembered him.

Some relatives who had once questioned him now praised his determination.

Jas smiled politely.

But inside...

He remembered something important.

The people who believed in him before success deserved the first phone calls.

His hostel friends.

His parents.

The teacher who encouraged him.

The students who had thanked him.

Those were the people he celebrated with first.

The next morning...

He opened the folder named **Lessons**.

Inside were hundreds of rejection emails.

He looked at them quietly.

Then he whispered,

"Thank you."

Without those rejections...

He would never have learned patience.

Without loneliness...

He would never have discovered writing.

Without uncertainty...

He would never have become a researcher.

Without failure...

He would never have appreciated success.

He didn't delete the folder.

He moved it into another folder called:

The Journey.

Because that's what it had always been.

His first day at work arrived.

As he walked into the office, he noticed something.

The security guard smiled.

"First day?"

Jas nodded.

"Congratulations."

"Thank you."

The receptionist welcomed him warmly.

His new colleagues introduced themselves.

Nobody asked,

"Why were you unemployed?"

Nobody asked,

"How many years did you struggle?"

They simply said,

"Welcome to the team."

For a moment...

Jas closed his eyes.

Years of waiting...

Had led to this ordinary sentence.

Welcome.

That evening, before leaving the office, he stood by the window overlooking the city.

The lights stretched toward the horizon.

He smiled.

Success didn't feel loud.

It felt peaceful.

Exactly the kind of life he had prayed for.

Back home, he opened his journal.

On a fresh page, he wrote:

Today I received an offer letter.

But the greatest gift wasn't employment.

It was becoming the man who could receive it with gratitude instead of pride.

He closed the notebook.

Tomorrow...

A new chapter of life would begin.

Not the end of the journey.

Simply...

The beginning of another climb.

Chapter 18 – Success Didn't Change Him

"The greatest success is not reaching the top. It is remaining the same kind person after you get there."

The first salary arrived on a quiet Friday afternoon.

Jas stared at the notification on his phone.

For years...

He had imagined this moment.

He thought he would shout.

Celebrate.

Buy something expensive.

Instead...

He simply smiled.

Then folded his hands.

"Thank You, Lord."

After work, he walked home instead of taking a taxi.

The evening breeze felt lighter than usual.

Nothing around him had changed.

The same streets.

The same tea shop.

The same sunset.

Yet everything felt different.

Not because money had arrived.

Because years of waiting had finally found an answer.

When he reached home, his mother was preparing dinner.

She noticed his smile immediately.

"You got your first salary?"

Jas nodded.

She smiled proudly.

"I knew it."

His father looked up from the newspaper.

"So..."

"What are you going to buy first?"

Jas thought for a moment.

Then smiled.

"I already decided."

The next morning...

Instead of visiting a shopping mall...

Jas visited the orphanage where he had spent time months earlier.

The children recognized him immediately.

"Brother Jas!"

They ran toward him.

He laughed as they surrounded him.

He had arranged lunch for everyone.

Simple food.

Rice.

Vegetables.

Sweets.

Nothing luxurious.

But enough to bring smiles.

One little girl asked,

"Is it your birthday?"

Jas smiled.

"No."

"Then why are we celebrating?"

He looked around the room.

"Because today...

God answered one of my prayers."

The children didn't completely understand.

But they clapped anyway.

Sometimes joy doesn't need an explanation.

Before leaving, the head of the orphanage thanked him.

"You didn't have to do this."

Jas smiled.

"I know."

"I wanted to."

As he walked outside, he remembered the promise he had made years ago.

If success ever came...

He would never celebrate it alone.

Life slowly found a new rhythm.

Mornings were no longer spent refreshing job portals.

Instead...

He traveled to work.

Met colleagues.

Solved problems.

Learned new technologies.

Asked questions.

Made mistakes.

Improved.

Every day felt like another lesson.

He loved it.

Not because the work was easy.

Because he finally belonged somewhere.

His manager soon noticed something unusual.

During meetings, Jas often connected ideas from different fields.

Software.

Healthcare.

Cybersecurity.

Artificial Intelligence.

Even aerospace.

One afternoon, the manager smiled.

"You think differently."

Jas laughed.

"I've had a lot of free time to think."

The room burst into laughter.

Months passed.

His confidence quietly returned.

Not arrogance.

Confidence.

There was a difference.

He no longer felt the need to prove his intelligence.

He focused instead on learning from everyone.

The senior engineers.

The interns.

The support staff.

Even the security guard at the entrance.

Every person knew something he didn't.

One evening, a new graduate joined the company.

The young engineer looked nervous.

He reminded Jas of himself years ago.

During lunch, the graduate asked,

"Sir..."

"Can I ask something?"

"Of course."

"I failed many interviews before getting this job."

"I still feel like I'm not good enough."

Jas smiled.

"I know that feeling."

"What did you do?"

Jas looked out the cafeteria window.

"I stopped comparing my first chapter to someone else's twentieth."

The graduate remained silent.

Then nodded slowly.

"I needed to hear that."

That night...

Jas opened his old email folder.

The one filled with rejection letters.

He didn't feel pain anymore.

Only gratitude.

Each rejection had taught him resilience.

Each disappointment had prepared him for responsibility.

He realized something.

If success had come earlier...

He might not have appreciated it.

Weeks later...

He received an invitation to speak at a nearby engineering college.

The topic was simple.

"Building a Career in Technology."

Standing on the stage, Jas looked at hundreds of students.

He smiled.

Years earlier...

He had sat exactly where they were.

Full of dreams.

Full of uncertainty.

He began quietly.

"I'm not here to teach you how to avoid rejection."

The auditorium became silent.

"I'm here to tell you what to do after it happens."

The students listened carefully.

He didn't show only his achievements.

He showed his failures.

His rejected applications.

His research setbacks.

His sleepless nights.

His self-doubt.

Then he smiled.

"And I'm standing here because I kept going."

The audience applauded.

Not because his journey had been perfect.

Because it had been honest.

After the seminar, a student approached him.

"Sir..."

"I've been thinking of giving up engineering."

Jas asked gently,

"Why?"

"I've failed too many times."

Jas smiled.

"How many?"

"Five."

Jas chuckled.

"I lost count after a hundred."

The student laughed.

For the first time that day.

Before leaving, Jas said,

"Don't let one season decide the rest of your life."

Later that evening...

He returned to his favorite place.

A hill overlooking the city.

The same place where he had once prayed during unemployment.

He stood quietly as the sun disappeared beyond the horizon.

The city lights slowly awakened below.

He whispered,

"Lord...

Thank You for not answering my prayers too quickly."

He smiled.

"I wasn't ready back then."

A cool breeze carried away the last light of day.

He understood now.

Success wasn't arriving late.

It had arrived exactly when his character was strong enough to carry it.

Back home, he opened his journal.

He wrote:

My salary changed my bank account.

But my struggles changed my heart.

If I ever forget where I came from...

May life remind me gently.

He closed the notebook.

Placed it beside the first notebook he had written years ago.

The pages were different.

The handwriting had matured.

But the message remained the same.

Never stop learning.

Never stop hoping.

Never stop being kind.

Outside...

The night sky stretched endlessly above the city.

Tomorrow would bring another day at work.

Another challenge.

Another opportunity to grow.

And Jas welcomed it with gratitude.

Because he had finally learned something that no university, interview, or offer letter could ever teach him.

The greatest achievement in life is not becoming successful.

It is becoming someone who deserves success.

Chapter 19 – The Dream Beyond the Horizon

"Dreams don't end when one comes true. They simply become the foundation for the next."

Three years had passed since Jas received his first offer letter.

Life had changed.

The boy who once refreshed job portals every hour now managed projects, mentored younger engineers, and continued publishing research in his spare time.

His desk was no longer filled with rejection emails.

Instead...

It held notebooks.

Research papers.

Travel plans.

And a map of the world hanging quietly on the wall.

One evening, a colleague walked into his office.

"Planning another trip?"

Jas smiled.

"I always am."

"You travel more than anyone I know."

"I waited years to start living."

"I don't want to waste another day."

His childhood dream had never changed.

Work hard.

Save honestly.

Travel simply.

Return with stories instead of expensive souvenirs.

He believed memories were worth more than possessions.

Whenever he visited a new place, he bought only one thing.

A postcard.

On the back of every postcard, he wrote one lesson that place had taught him.

His collection slowly grew.

From mountains.

Forests.

Coastal villages.

Historic cities.

Quiet temples.

Ancient churches.

Museums.

National parks.

Every postcard carried a memory.

Every memory carried gratitude.

One autumn morning, Jas stood at the foot of another mountain.

It wasn't Mount Everest.

Not yet.

But it was higher than any mountain he had climbed before.

Cold wind swept across the valley.

Snow rested gently on distant peaks.

He smiled.

One step closer.

Not to the summit.

To the dream.

A local guide noticed him staring toward the distant mountains.

"First time here?"

Jas nodded.

"Yes."

The guide smiled.

"You climb?"

"I try."

"Why?"

Jas looked toward the snow-covered peaks.

"Because mountains remind me that impossible things are climbed one step at a time."

The guide nodded.

"Good answer."

The climb lasted almost eight hours.

There were moments when Jas questioned himself.

His legs ached.

His backpack felt heavier.

The air became thinner.

Several hikers turned back.

One young traveler sat beside the trail, exhausted.

"I can't do this anymore," the traveler said.

Jas offered him a bottle of water.

"Take a break."

The traveler sighed.

"I wanted to reach the top."

Jas smiled.

"So did I."

"Then why aren't you rushing?"

"Because mountains don't reward people who hurry."

"They reward people who continue."

The traveler looked at him thoughtfully.

Several minutes later...

Both stood up.

And continued climbing.

Together.

At the summit...

Clouds drifted beneath their feet.

The world seemed wonderfully quiet.

Jas opened his backpack.

Inside was the same notebook he had carried through years of interviews.

He smiled.

Its pages had become worn.

Corners folded.

Ink slightly faded.

Yet it remained his closest companion.

He turned to the first page.

The goals he had written years ago were still there.

✓ Learn.

✓ Build.

✓ Help.

✓ Never Give Up.

Then he added a fifth line.

Leave the world a little better than you found it.

Months later...

His research work began receiving more attention.

Universities invited him to speak.

Students emailed him regularly.

Young engineers sought his advice.

One evening, while responding to emails, he noticed a message from a student in another country.

Sir, I almost quit engineering last year. After reading your book and your research, I decided to continue. Today I received my first internship.

Jas leaned back.

His eyes filled with tears.

Years earlier...

He had hoped one person might benefit from his journey.

Now...

Someone had.

He whispered,

"Thank You."

That weekend, Jas returned to his hometown.

His parents had grown older.

His father's hair had turned almost completely white.

His mother's hands showed the marks of years spent caring for the family.

During dinner, his father asked,

"Are you happy?"

Jas smiled.

"Yes."

His father nodded.

"Then you've become richer than many people."

After dinner, they walked together through the quiet streets.

The same roads Jas had walked during his unemployment.

The same tea shop.

The same bus stop.

The same small park.

Nothing had changed.

Except him.

He stopped beneath an old tree.

"I used to stand here after interviews."

His father smiled.

"I remember."

"I thought life had forgotten me."

His father placed a hand on his shoulder.

"Life wasn't forgetting you."

"It was preparing you."

That night, Jas sat on the rooftop once again.

Exactly where he had once cried in silence.

He looked toward the stars.

"So many nights..."

he whispered.

"I asked why."

He smiled gently.

"Now I ask..."

What's next?"

The answer arrived quietly inside his heart.

Keep learning.

Keep serving.

Keep exploring.

The following week, Jas received an invitation to join an international innovation forum.

Researchers from around the world would gather to discuss technology, healthcare, aerospace, and sustainability.

Years earlier, he would have doubted himself.

Now...

He accepted the invitation with gratitude.

Not because he believed he knew everything.

Because he believed learning never ended.

Before leaving for the forum, he visited the orphanage once again.

The children rushed toward him.

One little boy looked up and asked,

"Brother Jas..."

"When I grow up..."

"Can I become a scientist?"

Jas knelt beside him.

"You can become anything."

"But promise me one thing."

"What?"

"When you succeed..."

Help someone who is still climbing."

The boy smiled.

"I promise."

Jas smiled back.

Perhaps...

That promise mattered more than any award he could ever receive.

That evening he opened his journal.

He wrote:

Dreams are beautiful.

But they become meaningful only when they inspire someone else's dream.

My journey was never only about getting a job.

It was about becoming a light for someone walking through the same darkness.

He closed the notebook.

Outside...

The stars stretched endlessly across the sky.

Beyond them lay new adventures.

New mountains.

New discoveries.

And perhaps...

New dreams waiting just beyond the horizon.

Chapter 20 – Beyond the Rejection

"Life was never about avoiding rejection. It was about becoming someone who could still dream after hearing 'no' a thousand times."

The morning sun rose gently over the mountains.

Jas stood near a quiet lake, watching the golden reflection dance across the water.

A cool breeze carried the scent of pine trees.

Birds welcomed another day.

He smiled.

There had been a time when mornings began with anxiety.

Checking emails.

Refreshing job portals.

Wondering whether another rejection had arrived.

Now...

His mornings began differently.

With gratitude.

Years had passed.

The young man who once questioned his worth had become someone people looked to for guidance.

He had built a meaningful career.

Published research papers.

Written books.

Mentored students.

Traveled to places he had once only seen in photographs.

Yet, despite everything he had achieved, one thing never changed.

His humility.

His office desk looked surprisingly simple.

A laptop.

A notebook.

A family photograph.

A small globe.

And beside it...

A printed rejection email.

One of the oldest.

His colleagues often asked why he kept it.

He always smiled.

"Because I never want to forget where I started."

One afternoon he received an invitation to speak at a national innovation conference.

Hundreds of researchers.

Engineers.

Scientists.

Students.

Entrepreneurs.

The auditorium was filled.

As Jas walked toward the stage, applause echoed through the hall.

For a brief moment...

He remembered another stage.

Years ago.

A college event where he had struggled to speak.

Where interruptions had shaken his confidence.

Where he had gone back to his hostel feeling invisible.

Today...

He stood before another audience.

Not to prove himself.

But to encourage others.

He looked across the hall.

Then began quietly.

"My name is Jas."

"I've received hundreds of rejection emails."

Soft laughter spread through the audience.

"I've failed interviews."

"I've watched opportunities disappear."

"I've questioned myself."

"I've cried."

"I've started over more times than I can count."

The room became silent.

"But every rejection taught me something."

"It taught me patience."

"It taught me humility."

"It taught me that learning should never stop."

"And most importantly..."

"It taught me that your value is never decided by one person's opinion."

The audience applauded.

Not because he spoke perfectly.

Because he spoke honestly.

After the conference, a young woman approached him.

She looked nervous.

"Sir..."

"I've failed three competitive exams."

"My family thinks I should give up."

Jas smiled gently.

"I want you to remember something."

He took out his notebook.

Opened to the very first page.

It still carried the words he had written years ago.

Never stop learning.

Never stop hoping.

He handed the notebook to her for a moment.

"This notebook survived every rejection."

"So can you."

She smiled through tears.

"Thank you."

Months later, Jas finally began planning another dream.

Not a research paper.

Not a new job.

Not another book.

Mount Everest.

He knew the summit would demand years of preparation.

Training.

Fitness.

Discipline.

Patience.

He wasn't chasing a photograph.

He wanted to honor a promise he had made to himself years earlier.

Even if he never reached the top...

He wanted to be brave enough to try.

One weekend, he returned to his childhood school.

The old classrooms looked smaller now.

The playground felt quieter.

He walked slowly through the corridors.

Memories returned.

The loneliness.

The misunderstandings.

The moments that had once broken his confidence.

He stood silently for a while.

Then smiled.

Those memories no longer hurt.

They had become part of his story.

A teacher recognized him.

"Jas?"

He turned.

"Sir."

"I've heard about your work."

"I'm proud of you."

Jas smiled warmly.

"Thank you."

He meant it.

Holding onto bitterness would never change the past.

Forgiveness had given him peace.

That evening, he visited his parents.

His father was reading a newspaper.

His mother was making tea.

Nothing extraordinary.

Nothing dramatic.

Just home.

His favorite place in the world.

His father looked up.

"So..."

"Where next?"

Jas smiled.

"I don't know."

"Maybe another country."

"Maybe another mountain."

"Maybe another book."

His mother laughed.

"Whatever you do..."

"Don't forget to come home."

"I never will."

Later that night...

Jas climbed onto the rooftop.

Exactly where this journey had begun years ago.

The stars looked unchanged.

The same sky.

The same moon.

The same quiet wind.

He remembered every prayer.

Every tear.

Every rejection.

Every small victory.

He realized something.

None of it had been wasted.

Every disappointment had shaped him.

Every closed door had redirected him.

Every failure had strengthened him.

He opened his journal one final time.

On the last page he wrote:

If you're reading this...

Maybe you're searching for a job.

Maybe you've been rejected.

Maybe people have told you that your dreams are too big.

Don't stop.

Your journey doesn't end with rejection.

Sometimes rejection quietly protects you until you're ready for the life waiting ahead.

Keep learning.

Keep traveling.

Keep being kind.

Keep believing.

And when success finally arrives...

Reach back and help someone else climb.

He closed the journal slowly.

Looked toward the endless sky.

Smiled.

Tomorrow would bring another sunrise.

Another challenge.

Another opportunity to learn.

Life wasn't perfect.

It never would be.

But it was meaningful.

And for Jas...

That was enough.

Epilogue

Years later, readers would often ask Jas one question.

"Were these stories real?"

He would smile.

Some chapters were inspired by life.

Others were shaped by imagination.

But the message remained true.

Every dream is tested before it is trusted.

The boy who once collected rejection emails had become a man who collected memories.

He still traveled.

Still wrote.

Still researched.

Still photographed sunrises.

Still believed in people.

And every time someone thanked him for helping them continue after rejection...

He quietly whispered,

"Thank You, God."

Because he knew...

His greatest achievement was never getting a job.

It was never giving up before he did.

THE END

Epilogue

A few years later...

The inbox that once overflowed with rejection emails now contained invitations to speak, collaborate, and mentor.

Life had changed.

But Jas had not.

He still woke early to watch the sunrise whenever he could.

He still carried a notebook wherever he traveled.

He still believed that every person had a story worth listening to.

He still chose simple moments over grand celebrations.

Sometimes he returned to the small park where he had once sat wondering if life would ever change.

The same trees stood there.

The same benches.

The same evening breeze.

The only difference was the man sitting there.

Years ago, he had arrived carrying disappointment.

Now, he arrived carrying gratitude.

Not because life had become perfect.

But because he had learned that peace is not found in having everything.

It is found in appreciating what you already have while continuing to pursue what you hope for.

One afternoon, while speaking to a group of university students, someone asked him,

"Sir, if you could go back and erase every rejection from your life, would you?"

The room became silent.

Jas smiled.

He thought for a moment before answering.

"No."

The students looked surprised.

"If I erased my rejections, I would also erase the lessons they taught me."

"I would erase my patience."

"My compassion."

"My determination."

"I would erase the person I became."

He looked around the room.

"Success gave me opportunities."

"But rejection gave me character."

The audience applauded.

As the session ended, a student quietly approached him.

"Thank you," she said.

"I thought my journey had ended."

Jas smiled.

"No."

"Sometimes the road you're afraid of is the one leading you exactly where you're meant to be."

That evening, he stood beneath the open sky.

The stars looked exactly as they had during his hardest nights.

He folded his hands in gratitude.

The journey continued.

New dreams would come.

New challenges would appear.

New mountains would wait to be climbed.

But one thing would never change.

Hope would always walk beside him.

Author's Note

Dear Reader,

Thank you for spending your time with **Beyond the Rejection**.

This novel was written for everyone who has ever felt left behind.

For the graduate waiting for an opportunity.

For the dreamer who keeps hearing "no."

For the researcher whose ideas go unnoticed.

For the traveler who believes every journey teaches something valuable.

For anyone who has questioned their worth because life didn't go according to plan.

While this is a work of fiction, many emotions within these pages are inspired by real experiences shared by countless people who continue to pursue their dreams despite setbacks.

I believe rejection is not always the end of a story.

Sometimes it is the beginning of a stronger one.

If this book encourages even one person to continue learning, keep believing, or try one more time, then every hour spent writing it has been worthwhile.

No matter where you are in your journey, I hope you remember this:

Your value is not determined by a job title, a salary, or someone else's opinion.

Keep growing.

Keep exploring.

Keep creating.

And never stop believing that tomorrow can be better than today.

Thank you for reading.

With gratitude,

Mohamed Jassar

About the Author

Mohamed Jassar is an Indian author, independent researcher, and technology enthusiast with interests spanning aerospace, cybersecurity, artificial intelligence, innovation, and travel.

Alongside his passion for technology, he enjoys writing stories that explore resilience, hope, personal growth, and the quiet strength found in ordinary people facing extraordinary challenges.

His work is inspired by perseverance, lifelong learning, nature, and the belief that every setback carries the potential to become a new beginning.

When he is not writing or researching, he enjoys traveling, photography, trekking, exploring new places, and studying emerging technologies.

Beyond the Rejection is his second novel, following **A Thousand Reasons to Hope: Across the Ocean**.

He hopes his stories encourage readers to dream boldly, remain kind, and continue moving forward no matter how many obstacles they face.

"Dreams don't belong only to those who succeed. They belong to those who refuse to stop trying."

Mohamed Jassar